

Loving a Unicorn

Breeding a Future

Written by Arian Mabe

Birdsong played through the unicorn glade, a musical warble that no human hand could hope to reproduce. Pines and birches swayed together under the whim of a gentle breeze many miles from the nearest city. It was a place that humanity was yet to destroy and a tentative agreement with the localities kept most who wished to cause them trouble at a respectable distance. Few believed that unicorns even existed anymore and that was just the way the herd liked it, going about their business amongst their single storey abodes and meeting places. As sunlight played through the leaves of a glorious morning, there was no a unicorn in the herd that would have rather have been anywhere else.

All was not quiet, however. In the garden of the unicorn king and queen, Celeste braced herself against Christian's needy thrusts. The white unicorn grunted and threw her head up as her stallion bred her, his magically enlarged length driving in past the medial ring to the hilt. She shuddered and groaned, tail flagged and pushed eagerly to the side. The stallion grunted and scrambled for purchase on the mare as he slipped, eyes showing a rim of white. Celeste ducked her head, eyes bright and sides trembling with silent amusement: she wouldn't want to put him off. Although he had been a unicorn for several months, Christian was the first to admit that he sometimes found it difficult to keep his footing when mating with Celeste. It only served to amuse her, as much as she claimed him to be as steady as a stallion of many years in breeding.

Christian slowed, breathing laboured and muzzle dropping to lip softly at her mane and withers. But Celeste wasn't having any of that – they were far from done! The mare's head whipped around, violet eyes gleaming in the morning light.

"Come now, stud," she whinnied, a playful edge to her tone. "Are you so tired so swiftly? I wish for you to breed me!"

Christian flicked his ears but otherwise gave no indication that he had heard his partner, though his thrusts increased in force. Sides heaving, he let her take as much of his weight as their position allowed, and slammed in with desperate force. Celeste snorted, nostrils flaring, and held firm against the barrage of pleasure, that twist of ecstasy roiling closer and closer with each and every one of his thrusts.

A passing bay unicorn that Christian did not know on a personal level glanced at them through the open double doors, which were merely a pretence at closing off the garden from the village. Celeste caught his eye and winked, lips parted in a moan that would have been more befitting a human than one of her kind caught up in the throes of passion. In her distraction, orgasm claimed her and her forelegs half buckled beneath her, struggling to maintain her balance and composure as pleasurable ripples swam through her body, barely contained to her barrel. It seem that orgasm was indiscriminating in how release was delivered. Celeste gasped, sides moving quickly as she panted, the haze behind her eyes oh so slowly diminishing. By the heavens, could her stallion mount a mare! Well, after some training, of course.

It only took a few more thrusts for Christian to spill his seed inside and the stallion rumbled as he did so, tail flagging proudly. Celeste rolled her head from left to right, working out the kinks from unknowingly keeping it so stiff and arched through their liaison. No one ever said that unicorn mating was easy work. Though Christian would never be quite sure whether sex was more strenuous as a human or a unicorn – he'd never been truly tested. He slid backwards off the unicorn mare with a flick to his ears and a barely concealed spring to his hoof steps.

Rolling his head as climax died down all too quickly, a flutter in the corner of his eye drew his attention. High above, so high that they could have been mistaken for common hawks if he had not already known what to look for, were two brown gryphons. Their feathers caught the sunshine for the briefest of moments before they disappeared behind the trees. He shook himself. Surely they were too far away to cause any harm? He could not be certain, yet could not bring himself to alarm his life partner and spoil what had been the most perfect of mornings. With a sense of foreboding, he nuzzled Celeste's rump, chasing away thoughts of unease with her warm, earthen scent.

"You're picking up some of my language and how I say things, my love," Christian commented, if only to hide his unrest as his softening length drooped below his barrel. "Soon you'll be talking just like a human with slang and all!"

Celeste snorted and stomped, head high as she whirled to face him in a flurry of mane.

"I would never do such a thing!" She shook her mane off her neck. "That is an abomination to even consider, Christian. How would I ever find myself speaking like one of your kind?"

"I'm only teasing you."

He nuzzled her neck and Celeste grumbled, swatting him with her tail.

"Be that as it may, you have your studies to attend to."

"Already?" He looked up at the sun, gaining height in the sky. "It cannot be time to study already!"

"It is indeed time to delve into the scrolls. I believed you to be a scholar." Celeste tilted her horn to the side, blue waves of magic curling gently from the point. "Are you not enjoying your learning anymore?"

Celeste eyed him up and down, tail clamped over her hindquarters as her muscles tensed, twitching beneath her skin. She shook off imaginary flies and snorted, waiting on an answer that the shuffling stallion was reluctant to give. He danced from hoof to hoof, prancing uncomfortably on the spot as if he could escape from this particular line of questioning if he wished hard enough. But there was no evading the partner that knew him almost better than he knew himself. Christian hung his head, silvery horn nearly brushing the ground.

"I am..." Christian dragged the toe of his hoof through the grass. "I only wish I was better at magic. I can't match up to you."

Her eyes softened and she touched her nose to his, sharing breath in a warm whuff of air.

“Oh, Christian... It is not a competition,” she reassured him, lipping his cheek. “You will learn at your own pace. You truly have been remarkably swift considering your late introduction to the world of magic.”

He smiled, heart already feeling lighter even if he suspected her words were more to buoy up his spirits than with a strong element of truth.

“I have?”

“Of course.” Her lips quirked up in a smile. “You have been simply splendid, Christian. You should be proud of what you’ve learned in such a short span of time. You are already a strong asset to the herd’s talents with your unique knowledge.”

The flicker of gryphons flying overhead – could he have imagined it? – tickled at the back of his mind but he pushed the thought away. If there had been gryphons, the best he could do about it was continue with his magic studies, during the course of which every unicorn attending sessions was studying how they may protect and ensure the herd survived. It was a worthy cause – worthier than anything he had undertaken as a human attending university lectures. The stallion huffed softly. It had been too long since he’d seen his family, though he’d sent letters with Celeste’s assistance.

No. Study had to come first if the unicorns were to survive. Magic was the life blood of the herd and he had to keep his head down and *learn*. He had to improve, he had to be better. The herd had to survive. That was what he was there for, after all.

Nickering a farewell to Celeste, Christian trotted from the garden into the heart of the village where the younger unicorns gathered to study together under the guidance of a more learned stallion – a friend of his. He chuckled to himself as he went, earning himself some curious stares. Not all unicorns in the herd had gotten used to his quirks. Christian couldn’t help but laugh though. He hadn’t ever considered he’d have to go back to school as a unicorn.

Would a schoolboy’s cap be inappropriate?

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Christian swallowed hard and looked straight ahead at the ‘teacher’, trying to ignore the stares and nickers of the younger fillies around him. Although the most curious of the bunch were yearlings and older – very close to being mares – they had not the knowledge of years and he was still a novelty in the herd. If he had still been a human, Christian would have shrunk into himself and dragged the collar of his old jacket up under his ears as if he could disappear into it. He kind of missed that jacket.

Vale, the dun-coated teacher, had chosen an open-sided shelter for their lesson, allowing a refreshing breeze to kiss their coats as they studied. The unicorn herd milled about their business outside their shelter while the eager students clustered around tomes on magic, raised on stands so that they were placed at a more comfortable height for reading. The stallion teacher lowered his head to observe the magic of a black colt – the only one in the class – as he screwed up his muzzle fighting to lift a feather from the edge of one of the scroll holders.

Squeaking – he had not known horses could squeak until he had spent more time socialising with the younger fillies of the herd – a little grey filly sidled up to him, peering at his scroll on. Her mind was not on her work, however, and, as she tried to put the magic into practice, lifting her friend's hair from her neck. Levitation should have been a breeze with the studies at her back but her concentration was all too quick to slip with such a handsome stallion standing beside her and she zapped her friend's neck instead. Squealing indignantly, her friend snapped her teeth an inch from her neck and the grey filly jerked her head back, ears down to her skull as she bore her scolding with a sullen look.

“Have you found yourself settled, Christian?” The oldest of the young ladies, a pretty white filly speckled with grey from nose to hoof, enquired sweetly. Some of the younger ones were as forward as Celeste and Christian tried and failed to clear his throat – it wasn't in the equine throat to produce the noise – shuffling while he gathered himself. The speckled grey filly near enough fluttered her eyelashes and he desperately swung his gaze to Vale, taking category of his golden-brown coat, black tail and dark dorsal stripe running from his withers to his crop. Keeping his gaze resolutely away, he tried to pretend his sheath wasn't plumping with something he fought to deny. The tips of his ears turned pink. What would Celeste think?

“Er, yes, I'm settling very well, Mira,” he answered after a pause that he felt had been longer than necessary, hiding his discomfort. “How have you been this past moon?”

The filly bubbled away happily, as eager to talk as she was to listen, and he allowed himself to be soothed by the gentle, innocent warble of her speech. Less formal than Celeste, she tripped over her words and tied her tongue in knots, although he could not have imagined any human of a similar age – what was she? Three years old? – speaking as eloquently or fluently as she did. Unicorns matured in body and speech more swiftly, although it took them a similar length of time as humans to acquire emotional maturity, understanding the difference between right and wrong around the age of five, if his facts were correct.

Bobbing his muzzle, he excused himself from Mira and joined Vale at the side of the black colt, whose sides had become darkened with sweat. Whoever had said that magic wasn't a workout had been the greatest liar in the herd. Someone had said it, sometime after his transformation. Christian snorted, eyes brightening. They had been very wrong. It felt like it would be easier to run a marathon than go through one magical practice session sometimes! He still couldn't lift even a feather.

“Vale? Do you have a moment?”

The dun stallion raised his head, a smile in his eyes. His ebony horn glowed with a faint sheen of golden magic.

“Of course, Christian. Is there something I may be of assistance regarding?”

“Oh, many things.” The unicorn grinned. “You know what I'm like with magic. Though I practice every evening, as much as I'm able, I still don't feel like I'm getting anywhere with it.”

“It will come in time,” Vale said smoothly, keeping a careful eye on his charges out of the corner of his eye. “You have come into the talent with maturity when magic is, naturally, a force that develops with a unicorn.”

He shook his head, mane flopping to the other side of his neck. He wore it longer than most and it draped off the arch like a black waterfall.

“I believed you were having more success with bodily manipulation during the course of our last session?”

Christian hung his head.

“I only managed to create one spot on another unicorn’s coat, a change in their coat pattern,” he confessed, ears drooping. “I couldn’t replicate it and the spot faded before we’d even left the hut. It was a fluke – I couldn’t even do it on myself at home later.”

Vale pushed his nose into Christian’s shoulder, nickering with a flick of his tail.

“Come now! That is progress! You should be proud of what you have achieved in a short span of time, Christian. You have come far for a unicorn that was not born into the herd. We have great faith in you.”

“Everyone keeps saying that,” he grumbled. “But I can’t see it in myself.”

“You will in time.”

His confidence was not to be argued with, even if Christian could not bring himself to believe the unicorn, who was older than him by only a few years, as yet.

“It was not solely magic I was thinking to ask you about today though.”

He glanced around as if to ensure that none of the younger unicorns were listening but they were too wrapped up in their studies to pay attention to even him – or at least none of them were within usual hearing distance.

“I was with Celeste earlier and...” He hesitated. “Vale, there were gryphons flying overhead again.”

The stallion nodded gravely, all notion of good humour vanishing from his muzzle.

“I understand your concern. They have been encroaching further and further into our territory.”

“Do you think they know where the herd is?” Christian flicked his tail, shifting his weight from hoof to hoof – there seemed to be no comfortable position.

“Absolutely.” The stallion’s words made Christian’s heart sink and he lowered his tone as he stepped closer. “There is more to this quest of ours, our quest for the herd’s survival.”

He cast a troubled look at the black colt, the prodigy of the class, showing off with a prance in his step as he levitated his feather all around the shelter.

“There is less and less magical potential in the youngest members of the herd,” he said in a voice barely above a whisper. “It is not fair to the younglings to compare them to myself but even others studying with me expressed greater magic than what I have borne witness to here.”

He hesitated, eyes glassy. Birds sang outside the shelter, flitting through the trees, blissfully oblivious to the harsh glare of knowledge shared between the unicorns. Christian wished he could close his ears against the stallion’s words, yet they were words he needed to hear. Perhaps he’d been playing at magic when he should have been fighting a war...

“I am afraid that there is no hope for us. Magic is our life blood and, without magic...”

Vale trailed off, working his jaw as if to clear something from his mouth. Near the rear of the shelter, a filly laughed, though Christian could not tell who was so amused. Against his will, the thought of losing Celeste streaked through the front of his mind and he snapped mentally at the threat, fight or flight instinct making magical sparks build up in his horn. It was the only time that his horn seemed keen to show magic, when he was emotionally strung out.

The unicorn shot the sparks towards the hut’s roof in a shower of blue that dissipated, thankfully harmlessly. He wouldn’t have wanted to accidentally scorch another useless hole in a shelter, at least if he didn’t intend to. There had to be a way. He braced himself against a foe he could not see, hooves digging into the soft, bare earth as he met Vale’s gaze levelly.

“If we build up our magic as much as possible,” Christian tried, “surely we at least have a chance at holding off the gryphons long enough for something more to be found?”

He was clutching at straws and he knew it, as hopeless as their plight seemed in the moment. He hadn’t allowed the unicorns to transform him only to fall when the furlong turned uphill.

“There was one tome I considered...” Vale’s ears perked up and he lifted his front hooves from the ground in the suggestion of a rear, excitement making his muscles twitch beneath his skin. “Come!”

Turning on his hoof, he strode to a pile of scrolls cradled in a cotton sling that kept them up from the floor and protected from wayward hooves. He sifted through them carefully, lifting each one in turn with a purple glow of magic, and snorted as he found the one he was looking for, horn shooting off sparks in his excitement.

“Now here...” He unrolled the scroll carefully in midair, folding it back over itself so that it did not touch the grass. “Here is something, Christian. I wouldn’t wish to bore you with the intricacies – you must, of course, be looking to return to your studies – but here...”

He trailed off, eyes searching the neatly inscribed letters for exactly what he was looking for. It had to be precise – it was always that way with Vale. Christian shifted his front hooves, doing his best to wait for the stallion to find his own words. He had a sense that there was importance behind them. Maybe he could uncover something more himself?

“Ah!” Vale threw up his head. “Here it is!” He read off the scroll. “As magic flows through the herd like a river from the mountains to the ocean, unicorns are as much a part of magic as magic is of unicorns. One cannot exist without the other. The cycle of life must continue in

order for the world and unicorn kind to survive. It has been this way since the first magical records were transcribed and shall be so until the end of time.”

Vale whinnied, drawing the attention of the nearest fillies, who looked his way with quivering noses. Christian blinked.

“We know already that magic and unicorns are intended to co-exist,” he said, head tilted to one side as he considered the scroll for himself. “Forgive me, but this is hardly fresh information.”

“Do you not see?”

Vale could barely contain himself in his excitement, prancing on the spot and flicking out his fore-hooves as if he had become a colt once again, full of life and innocence. It was a shame his world had turned him to seriousness so soon.

“The cycle of life,” he repeated. “Breeding. Magical breeding. Unicorn breeding!”

Christian’s eyes widened, nostrils shivering in the hint of a whinny.

“Then it is exactly as we suspected! Celeste was right all along! We do need more stallions in the herd!”

Christian half-reared, pawing the air. He forgot the fillies watching and hastily dropped back to all four hooves, hiding behind his muzzle. Licking his lips, he pretended that he hadn’t done anything out of the ordinary as Vale turned his head politely away, concealing his smile. Yet the stallion bobbed his muzzle, openly pleased that Christian had come to the same conclusion as he had. They worked well together, as a team.

“I believe there is more to it than what the text says,” Vale mused, snuffling over the worn parchment, “but I cannot glean any more from it at this time. I am too close to the subject. Would you care to think it over?” He looked up hopefully. “With your scholarly work at your back, Christian, you have a different perspective. A fresh pair of eyes may do us wonders in uncovering the truth.”

“I will. May I take the scroll away with me? I assure you I will take immaculate care of it in your absence.”

Vale rolled the scroll with magic as his answer and held it up for Christian to take. His horn illuminated with blue magic and he reached to take it. As his magic touched the curling edge of the parchment, he hesitated, Vale waiting with his horn tilted expectantly.

“Heh...” He tried to rub the back of his neck with a hand he’d forgotten he didn’t have anymore. “A bag of some kind may be more appropriate for me. I wouldn’t want to damage it. It’s too important to take undue care with.”

The stallion had the good grace to not question his choice of carrying the scroll and, with some digging to the bottom of his sling of scrolls, located a sliver of a cotton bag that had held another of the more fragile scrolls. Christian thanked his lucky stars that unicorns had learned long ago how to manipulate and use cotton. It made carrying items, at least for the

time being, more feasible than if he had to conduct his carryings solely with the use of magic he could barely call upon. The unicorn tried not to dwell on that fact, accepting the cotton bag from Vale, very carefully, with his teeth. He dropped the loop of the bag over his head with a skilled flick of his neck that dropped the loop neatly past his horn and ears. He snorted, pleased with his control over his four-legged body if nothing else. He'd become well used to it over the months and no longer struggled to keep his hooves.

"As for the gryphons, Christian..." Vale shot the fillies a deliberate look, the spotted lass immediately pretending to have not been eavesdropping. "I cannot speak openly here but I am confident the king and queen shall have more information for you. If not of your own accord, they will shortly be calling you to meet officially."

He shot Christian a look and the unicorn nodded, understanding the implication behind his words.

"Of course, Vale. Perhaps it would be best if Celeste and I made our way to meet with them immediately?"

Vale nodded.

"Celeste would know their whereabouts better than any member of the herd, except perhaps for their advisors," he confirmed. "You should go now – study can wait. But do come again next session, Christian." A smile gleamed in the corner of his eye. "Your admirers, in particular, would miss you sorely."

"Excuse me."

A small voice drew their attention and the stallions started to see a white filly beside them. She stole upon them without making a sound and Christian swallowed hard, wondering exactly how much she had heard.

Vale recovered more quickly.

"Yes, Karin?" Vale smiled. "What may I be of assistance with this afternoon?"

The filly swallowed and ducked her head, peering up at the older stallions through a haze of frizzy forelock. His eyes wandered and he was struck, not for the first time, how like Celeste she was. With the same silver horn and hooves, they could have been related, right down to the soft, pink muzzle. Only her eyes were different – a startling green like pools of moss from the depths of the forest.

Christian smiled with Vale. It was difficult not to like the quiet little filly and her sweet disposition. He rarely saw her with her nose out of scrolls, though she was irrefutably focused on her studies. Often rather close to him too. Christian's stomach churned.

He shook his head. A lot of the fillies liked to be close to him during their lessons. He was an unwelcome distraction, even if he did not like to be. Sometimes his studies were better carried out in the privacy of his new home.

Karin peered around her forelock, slow to respond as her tongue seemingly stuck to the roof of her mouth.

“I would like to learn about transformation magic, if only the beginning elements and components. It is beyond my skills at this present time to consider without further instruction, Vale.”

Christian was struck by how formal she sounded even at a young age, although he had to remember that the filly was maturing. Her years did not make her any less intelligent, not with the time she devoted to her studies. Christian warmed. He had to admire that.

Vale blinked thoughtfully and glanced at his scrolls, withdrawing one from the sling with a soft murmur.

“I have something here that may be of use to you, but allow me to first demonstrate some. Do you think you can secure a volunteer for practice, Karin?”

She nodded and looked to Christian with the biggest, roundest, most pleading eyes he had ever seen on a filly. The stallion’s head shot up and he looked from left to right, tail swishing.

“Christian is just leaving, unfortunately.”

Vale had the quickness of mind to step in before things escalated and Christian made good his exit as Karin dropped her head. He nodded his farewell to Vale and made a beeline for the perimeter of the hut, pausing only once to check that his precious cargo was still tied securely around his neck.

Leaving the shelter, Christian could not help but glance back at the despondent filly, forced to find another partner to practice transforming a living being. It did not have to be a unicorn in order for transformation magic to work, only that it was easier to use the natural magic of unicorns to practice transformation than force an inanimate object to change.

His heart twisted. He should have given more time to the filly. He’d have to make it up to her next time they came across one another in their magic sessions. Christian sighed, barrel slowly rolling.

Now, however, he would have to speak to the king and queen.

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“Christian? What has you frightened?”

The stallion’s tail flicked as they walked through the gently curving hallways of their home – the castle on the edge of the unicorn village. It offered them enough privacy that unexpected guests were rare and one of the first places that Christian had been able to become used to and trial his new body after his transformation. He would forever be grateful for a place to retreat to and the hallway with a smooth wooden floor and branches arcing across held an air of peace that normally soothed his heart.

“I’m not frightened,” he snorted, shaking his mane from his neck. “How would you know if I was scared?”

Celeste inclined her head, violet eyes darkening. There was no laughter behind them, only trouble.

“You have clamped your tail down. You are not moving a single human inch.”

One of the curses of his new body. Christian licked his lips and brushed her muzzle lightly with his, reassuring her with the touch of his body. She pushed into him with a soft nicker, pressing close to his side as they entered the reception room, which was open, airy and boasted a large opening through which they could look out over the elaborate, well tended gardens. A barely visible magical barrier took the place of a window, flickering and dancing in the edge of Christian’s peripheral vision. Despite living with the unicorns for some time, he still couldn’t help applying human terms to what he saw, relating to it the best he could. Interestingly, if the unicorns did want privacy, the ‘window’ could be coloured with magic so as to obscure the beings inside from view. He only supposed it could also be made soundproof. Now that was magic he would like to learn.

The king and queen entered the room on soft hooves, eyes dark and serious. Celeste was their mirror image, the whole family graced with a pure white coat and pink skin. Their horns rose silver from the centres of their foreheads as their like-coloured hooves gleamed and Christian was glad, not for the first time, that Celeste had also chosen to make him in their image. It made him feel like one of the family – a notion that he was sure had been deliberate.

Moirin touched noses with her daughter, the unicorns breathing in each other’s scents. The ‘youngest’ unicorn stood still, unsure of what to do in the instance of family affection and thought with a pang of his own mother. She still didn’t understand his choice to become a unicorn – he wasn’t sure she even believed him. But he would see her again soon; he would make it happen. Christian smiled sadly. At least he had an adopted family of sorts in the unicorn herd. Caderyn snorted and greeted Christian with a flick of his tail, ears pricked to attention.

“Mother, father,” Celeste nickered. “Christian has called us here today, although I cannot claim to know intimately the reasoning behind it.”

Christian scuffed a hoof across the floor.

“I meant to tell you Celeste.”

“Time was short,” she acknowledged. “Yet I am keen to hear what it is you have to say in such secrecy. You have ensured our privacy for a reason.”

He nodded once, muscles shivering.

“There’s no point hiding it – there’s been more and more gryphon activity. Have you not seen it?” He addressed the king and queen directly and caught himself a moment later. “Of course you have, I’m sorry. I meant more what is being done about it? I fear that, if we ignore this approach, we will secure our fate within months, if not weeks.”

He paused, eyes serious. Celeste gave a tiny toss of her head, nostrils flared.

“Are we to turn and fight them?” He asked honestly, voicing the question that had been running around his mind for weeks: it had had to come out sooner or later.

Moirin shook her head and looked at the floor, ears slanting to the sides of her head. Her husband stepped closer, supporting her with the warmth of his body pressed to hers, a presence that Christian understood as comforting for unicorns. In all honesty, for him, Celeste was a bit of a radiator when touching the length of her body to his side.

Celeste stamped and snaked her head up, snorting and twitching her ears as if to listen out for a threat that may come at any time.

“When did you see gryphons last, Christian?” She demanded, ears back. “Why did you not inform me? Were you in my presence?”

He’d never seen her ears go back before, except when chasing off the gryphons that one time by the lake, and that little fact alone was enough to glue his tongue to the roof of his mouth. Should he have told her? Should he have interrupted the moment?

“I...er...well...” Christian blushed, ears turning pink. “It was earlier. In the garden.”

Celeste blinked.

“Then we were together. Why did you not tell me?”

Christian groaned inwardly, staring at the wooden floor as if, with enough wishful thinking, it would gape open and swallow him up whole as the mare flicked her tail. She hated waiting for an answer and he knew it. The stallion gulped and smiled sheepishly. Let her have the truth then, if she was so adamant for it. Was there any right answer anyway?

“We were a little preoccupied.”

No, he couldn’t quite get his tongue around the words but Celeste understood, a giggle of a whinny tickling her lips.

“Oh, Christian.” She pushed her head into his chest, all transgressions forgotten. “You are a most peculiar stallion at times. Why would you not be clear in saying that we were engaged in mating?”

He squealed and back away, ears back and eyes wide. Moirin and Caderyn laughed, their whinnies breaking the tension in the air.

“Celeste! How could you just say it like that? It sounds so crude! And in front of your parents!”

The mare snorted and flicked her tail, catching him a light yet stinging blow across his foreleg as she swung her hindquarters around. He jumped and shook himself as his mate’s eyes sparkled, a smile dancing within her perfect, violet orbs. He could lose himself in her eyes if he was not careful to remember reality.

“Unicorn mating is hardly a private affair, Christian. There is no reason for it to be. It is a natural part of life.”

Celeste tilted her head.

“You are so strange sometimes, Christian. We had our first mating as stallion and mare in front of my parents. Do you not remember?”

How could he forget? The stallion held his breath and closed his eyes. It was a dream, it just had to be. He would open them again to find himself in the bedchamber with Celeste, surrounded by her sweet, horsey scent and swaying on his hooves as he woke from a sound slumber, ready to face another day. Or perhaps not so sound, if his dreams were so cruel upon this particular night.

Unfortunately, when he opened them again, it was only to be presented with the faces of his love’s sire and dam, both barely restraining their laughter as their sides trembled.

“It was a wonderful ceremony,” Caderyn added unhelpfully, unable to keep the grin off his whiskered muzzle, a tuft of hair curling from his chin. “I did not believe that a freshly transformed stallion could breed a mare so many times and only fall from his hooves on a mere three instances – a truly impressive feat!”

Christian rolled his eyes and shook his head, mane scratching a neck that was becoming decidedly sweaty, darkening in crude patches. It was difficult to hide embarrassment as a unicorn but he still didn’t understand how they could be so open about mating. He did it for Celeste’s pleasure – she wouldn’t allow him to say no, anyway, when his cock was dropping – and, true, that first time as a stallion he had gotten himself caught up in the moment. But it didn’t come naturally to him. Surely he should be seducing his lady sweetly and softly to their bedchambers for a night of passionate lovemaking? And not being lovingly teased by her parents?

Unicorns did not yet make complete sense to the former human.

“Right, of course.” His ears burned and, as the ground clearly was not going to swallow him up in the immediate future, he pressed on. “Back on topic then. I was speaking to Vale and he was saying that we could be right in thinking about bringing

“The answer is clear.” Caderyn glanced at Moirin, gazes grazing in a knowing instant of certainty. “Breeding with Celeste is not going to foal the number of unicorns we require to save the herd.”

Christian’s face fell and he looked at his hooves, heart sinking as quickly as his hopes had risen. Every lead brought him to another dead end! Was there nothing he could do to save the unicorns? To save Celeste?

“Then there is no hope? We must find another way?” He said numbly, forcing his lips to form the words.

The king shook his head reassuringly, expression soft enough to draw Christian back from the edge of despair. He lifted his head, whuffing quietly as Celeste's lips brushed his shoulder. The concern in her eyes was as deep as his.

"In a sense, we must venture down a different path, yes." Moirin was gentler in her approach, nudging her smirking husband to the side. "I fear I must be upfront with you, however, Christian." She gathered herself, sides expanding in a deep breath. "How would you feel about breeding other mares, Christian?"

The stallion blinked. Other mares? There was only Celeste.

"Oh!" Celeste danced on her hooves. "Then we would bring more foals into the herd more quickly with more colts beside the stallions! Breeding will improve the strength of the herd!"

Christian's jaws dropped but the unicorn family moved on without him, bouncing off each other's flow of thoughts with unerring accuracy and speed.

"You always were swift to dive to the heart of a matter, Celeste." Her mother nodded approvingly. "Yes, it is a conclusion we have already come to. Not only Christian but the other stallions of the herd must engage in as many mating sessions as possible to bring in more unicorns and more magic. There is no greater complication to it than that."

He swung his head towards Celeste, panic chasing his hooves to shift and scrape obnoxiously over the floor – he forgot to pick them up in his haste. Surely Celeste would be outraged? Why was she nodding? The unicorn mare pranced and snaked her neck back and forth, excitement flowing through her body as magic thrummed outwards from her skin in a golden glow that encased her from head to hoof.

When it spread outwards, brushing Christian's flank, he squealed and backed away, ears flat to his skull. How could she have so many thoughts going through her head? The golden aura sent a zap of energy through him that still tingled and he shook away the transferred thoughts of him with his cock bouncing, spinning up on to his hind hooves to take mare after mare, the very essence of stallion virility.

"I can't do that!" He blurted, hooves splayed as if he didn't know in which direction he wanted to run. "I'm with Celeste! It wouldn't be right! I'm not even any good at magic! There's nothing in me that would benefit a foal and the magic of the herd especially."

He threw the last bit in as his last hope but it caught Moirin's attention. The mare's horn lit up with a pink glow and she reached out a tendril of magic to caress his dished cheek. He trembled away from the light touch. It felt like a human hand

"But Christian..." She turned her smoky gaze on him. "You have magical potential in you that is exceptionally promising. Vale has spoken with me already. It is locked inside, even though you are struggling to unleash it. It will come, in time. Yet it is there, waiting to be used."

Christian snorted and shook his head. That was laughable. Moirin was kind – too kind. She was only trying to make him feel better.

“I speak only the truth, Christian,” she insisted, pressing on regardless of his blatant lack of belief.

“Then what has Vale said?” He demanded.

His ears fell obnoxiously back to his skull and he flicked his tail, shifting his weight as the family of unicorns exchanged looks. The tip of Celeste’s horn glowed violet to match her eyes and Caderyn nodded, somehow managing to put a grave edge into the motion. How did someone even manage that? Christian dropped his head, ears drooping, and hid behind his forelock. Sometimes he could not help but feel like an outsider in their midst when they conferred amongst themselves, glances and subtle shifts of their bodies more than enough to convey their thoughts to one another. Yet he wanted to be one of them. Doubt flashed through his mind, pushing away brighter thoughts of his time spent living with the unicorns. Was he one of them?

Of course he was. Christian shook himself, white hairs floating to the floor as they were dislodged from his coat. Celeste nickered and stretched out her head towards him, long lashes drawing his attention as she blinked slowly. Magic emanated from her horn in a sinuous tendril and she brushed his lips with the very tip of it. He shuddered from the flash of warmth, which left a tingling sensation in its wake. She’d never quite used her magic in that way before but the warmth dropped down to his stomach where it spread, soothing tension from muscles he had not realised were stiff.

“Vale has not spoken of you in anything besides a positive light, Christian,” Celeste said at last, her gentle tone soothing to his ringing ears. “He has only said that you have an incredible aptitude for magic, lurking beneath the surface. It only needs to be unleashed.”

She nuzzled his cheek, lips tickling over the short hair.

“How we may release your magic, I do not know. Yet I trust Vale. He has an innate knowledge of these matters and, if I may be perfectly honest with you, my love, he has never been wrong as yet.”

Putting her head alongside Christian’s, she held his gaze with one eye, unable to look at him directly with both simultaneously due to the configuration of her face. Smiling, she bopped him gently on the side of his muzzle, between the dish of his cheek and chin, and he felt himself smile in return.

“I trust him,” she said simply, needing no more words to convey her point.

Christian pondered this and pushed the thoughts that told him he wasn’t good enough to perform adequate magic for the herd right to the back of his mind. It took a colossal effort but he succeeded in squashing them down – at least for the time being. No doubt they were return to haunt him when sleep claimed him, dreams chasing his heels of foals that would never be. There were more important matters to focus on, however, than whether or not he would be sufficient for the herd. He could only try and that was as much as they could ask of him.

Steeling himself, the unicorn took a deep breath.

“Tell me more about what you would have me do. Would this be okay with you, Celeste? It seems awfully...” He cast about for the right words. “Callous. It’s callous for me to be with another unicorn. It’s unfaithful. It feels *wrong*.”

The word was childish and simplistic but it was all that it boiled down to really. Wrong. It was wrong. How could he mate another unicorn? Guilt nudged the back of his mind and he remembered the filly – well, mare – from his magic lessons, flirting and flicking her tail at him as if she wanted him to mount her right there and then. And little Karin with the sweet, kind eyes and pink nose, so like Celeste. He couldn’t say that they didn’t stir a need in him. Yet he didn’t feel it was something he could voice aloud.

Caderyn stepped forward, taking the floor.

“If you accept this, you will have your pick of mares in the herd – usually ones without life mates already, unless there are some that put themselves forward. Some see it as their duty, although we have never requested it of those already with partners. You will be asked to mate with them as many times as you are physically able and they are willing to take you. The herd is willing to provide magical supplements to increase your virility and stamina for this feat.”

He grimaced.

“With so few stallions, it became necessary to develop these potions simply to keep the herd alive. It is not our proudest magical creation.”

Christian swallowed and glanced at Celeste as if for reassurance – could he do this? Was it right? – but the mare’s eyes were glassy as she imagined. Noticing his look, she tipped her horn to his and shared her thoughts. Images of Christian – viewed as if through Celeste’s eyes – flooded his mind and his skin prickled to see himself mounting a palomino mare, arousal drooling from her marehood. Another winked ahead of him, tail held high as her cunny clenched, two pairs of udders swinging oh so temptingly beneath her barrel. What stallion could resist such a temptation? He mounted the bay mare next, catching her mane between his teeth as he drove in, a masculine grunt rumbling from his chest. He pounded her like a stallion possessed until she cried out in climax and he dismounted, cock hardly softening as a stream of cum poured from her marehood, which held itself open in a slight gape. The brown coated unicorn looked back at him and stamped, nickering a demand for more even as her legs trembled.

And then there was the quiet little Karin, head coyly lowered as she raised her tail and begged me sweetly to mount her, to take her, to breed her. She claimed she would have my foal and danced from hoof to hoof until the stallion in Celeste’s imaginings reared up to let her bear his weight and pushed into her winking, needy marehood. Christian gulped, though did not pull away, screwing up his eyes as Moirin and Caderyn looked on, unaware of what was being shared between the lovers. He didn’t know why Celeste had chosen that filly in particular to bring into the fantasy but his cheeks and ears burned to have her placed before him so sexually. The filly was sexually mature, of course, and couldn’t really be called a filly. But she was so young and innocent in comparison to Celeste... His thoughts wandered and he dragged my horn away from Celeste’s with difficulty, embarrassed at the needy grunt that groaned up from the back of his throat.

It was difficult to press himself back into the mould of the situation at hand as the unicorn king and queen coughed quietly, reminding them of their presence. Caderyn's eyes brimmed with questions but his partner pushed his shoulder, eyes warning him. Christian bit back a laugh. There could be a whole comedy show about those two, truly, ever the typical husband and wife in unicorn terms. Yet there was no question where their hearts lay.

"Will you be able to complete this task, Christian?" Caderyn asked seriously, muzzle wrinkling as he took a more serious measure of the stallion. "It is a high task to ask of any stallion and not one we have requested so formally in the past. All stallions in the herd are asked to mate with as many mares as possible in order to keep the herd strong, or as strong as the herd may be."

"Even you?"

The words escaped him before he could call them back and his jaw fell slack. Caderyn had bred unicorns other than Moirin? Was he unfaithful? Why would any stallion not be as faithful to their mate as they could be? There was the need for foals, yes, of course, but surely that could be achieved with their life partner too?

Panic fluttered in his chest and he backed away, tail pinned to his rump. Regardless of what Caderyn had or had not done, he could not betray Celeste like that. It simple was not going to happen, no way, no how. But Caderyn was nodding and Celeste giggled, lips quivering as she whinnied and followed Christian, butting her head into his shoulder. He winched as her hard horn clipped his withers and she murmured an apology.

"Yes, even myself," Caderyn acknowledged. "I perform my duty, although it is difficult for most stallions to sire foals – the seed does not often take – as you are already aware. But this magical potential Vale has sensed within you..." He mulled over his words before continuing. "You may be the key to this, Christian. We can but try. You may be the hope we were searching for all these decades."

Christian couldn't disagree with that as the stallion echoed his own thoughts intimately. He would always try, for the herd *and* for Celeste. He'd do anything and everything for her sake.

The mare pranced, tail held high as she whipped around Christian in a tight circle, nipping at his tail like a foal at play.

"It will be wonderful! I am sure this is what we must do!" She cried, flipping up into a rear and pawing at the air. "Christian, it will be delightful to watch you! Though do not think that you will be able to shirk your 'duties' with me also."

She cast him a flirty smile and winked her marehood at him, facing her parents so they could not quite see her openness, even if it could be inferred. Swallowing, Christian struggled out to look as the mare burred on in a stream of conversation, tail flicking back and forth so his eye was constantly drawn to her winking cunny. He could have cursed her in that moment, as much as he loved her, as his cock swelled within his sheath, plumping out obviously.

"Christian, I already have several mares in mind for you," she gushed, more life in the fluid dance of her body than he had seen in days, if not weeks. "Aisling has inferred that she would like to spend time with Christian and we are all well aware of what that means, are we not?"

She didn't wait for an answer and ploughed on.

"There is also Nandag, Madisyn, Innis, Marsaili, Alina and, of course, Karin. None of these mares have taken life partners as yet – there are no stallions of free rein for them to choose from." Christian tried not to react when the filly's name was mentioned, something tightening within his chest. "They will all, I am confident, be interested in this proposition, this endeavour to bring magic and life back to our herd."

Moirin chuckled at her daughter, exhaling softly as the younger mare pranced and flicked up her hooves, showing off for her partner. Even if he did not quite know how to react to her exuberance as yet.

"Oh, Christian!" Celeste dropped a kiss on his cheek, eyes shining. "It will be the most amazing event – a celebration! I cannot w

"We will have to secure the potions ahead of time," Caderyn interjected. "Do not forget that we must ensure Christian has everything he requires to complete the task. It is, however, a most pleasurable task."

He caught Christian's eye and winked, his gaze portraying nothing but innocence even as Moirin squealed and poked her horn into his side. Caderyn and Celeste chuckled, the mare lifting her front hooves from the floor as she bobbed her muzzle decisively.

"Of course, I am sure we will..."

Celeste trailed off, head drooping as she swayed on her hooves, eyes glazed and unfocused. Christian rushed to her side, supporting her with the bulk of her body as her hooves splayed, tail lax over her hindquarters. Her father snorted and jumped, muscles shuddering as his daughter struggled for balance.

"Celeste! What's wrong?" Christian nudged her neck, trying to glean a response – any words at all! – from her lips. "Are you sick? Did you eat something funny? Do you need to go to the bedchamber? Should I call a doctor?"

"What's a doctor?" She finally said, eyes bleary. "I am not unwell, Christian, I am sorry to frighten you. I only felt faint for a moment. I am quite well now, I did not mean to cause such a disturbance."

Celeste and her mother exchanged a look that Christian could not fathom as the older mare started forward, eyeing her daughter all over as if she was going to turn into a snake before her very eyes.

Caderyn, on the other hand, was not quite so composed. The stallion danced and jumped from side to side, pushing himself off his hind hooves with the strength of a younger stallion.

"Celeste, are you confident you are quite well?" Her father stretched out his nose to her, reaching for her with tendrils of magic. "This is most unlike you. Has something happened? Are you taken ill?"

“Leave the poor mare alone, Caderyn.” Moirin gently supported Celeste on the other side, keeping her close between Christian and herself. “I believe she only needs to rest a while. It has been a long day, has it not, Celeste? Were you not up at first light?”

The mare nodded sheepishly.

“Yes, mother. I left the castle early this morning. I did not think anyone would have noticed. I tried to be as quiet as possible.”

Christian started.

“Celeste, why did you leave the castle without me?”

The mare licked her lips and looked up at him, abashed.

“I wanted to think. The gryphon threat has been...how do you say it? It has also been preying on my mind. I needed to think and sleep deserted me too early this morning.”

He nodded. He could understand that, though he certainly didn’t want her to worry. Caderyn snorted and, as if he didn’t quite believe the mares, looked them over from head to hoof until Moirin chased him off with a snap and flick of her tail.

“We are quite well, thank you, you old nag. Please, let Celeste rest. This is nothing that a good night of sleep will not cure.”

Caderyn hoisted his head up high and shook his mane off his neck.

“If that is what you claim...” He trailed off doubtfully. “Then please rest, Celeste. This conversation and the detail entailed may be undertaken at a later time when you are less fatigued.”

Celeste exhaled slowly, a smile returning to her muzzle. She suddenly struck Christian as much older than her years, although they were technically close in age.

“Thank you, father, I will make sure that I rest for the remainder of the day.”

Despite her condition, she could not stop herself in time from shooting Christian a cheeky look, tongue poking out from the corner of his mouth so only he could see.

“And Christian shall take further steps towards saving the herd. He will have much to tell me of your plans and which mares will step forward by the next morning, if my gut speaks correctly of this.”

*

Christian was, to say the very least, nervous. Celeste chose a quiet glade set apart from the village for his comfort and some sense of privacy. There wouldn’t be much privacy, however, with every mare not currently being bred watching the show and waiting their turn to be mounted, winking and pleading and teasing as Celeste promised they would. He shuffled back and forth, unable to even appreciate the warmth of dappled sunlight through the trees

on his coat and the light breeze tickling his mane over the arch of his neck. Every muscle was tensed like a coiled spring as he waited and waited and waited. Although it had only been a few minutes, if that, it felt like forever.

Hi, nice to meet you. I'm Christian and I'm here to be your stud for the evening. Shall we get started?

He shuddered. No! How was he supposed to greet the mares when they arrived? Certainly not like that! What would he say? What would he do? Well – he snorted – what he would do was already decided. Celeste stood by his side with a cotton bag draped over her withers. Within lay the potions and herbs he would need to carry out his task, although he wasn't sure how breeding several mares could be considered such. Thinking of it as an honour was more apt by far.

And nerve wracking. Heart wrenchingly nerve wracking.

“Celeste?” He asked, not for the first time. “How much longer? Are they not going to come? Are you *sure* this is okay with you? You want me to do this?”

The mare rolled her eyes and pawed the grass, digging up clods of dirt.

“It is far more than merely ‘okay’ with me, Christian. You have asked me this several times prior to this instance. Please do not ask me again.” Red sparks tingled at the tip of her horn. “For the answer will still be the same no matter how many times you ask. Do you not wish to carry out the mating session?”

“No! It's not that, not that at all,” he backtracked hastily. “It's just not normal for humans to take several mates or have sex with anyone else if they are already with someone. We're monogamous. It's...really weird for me to think of. Even if...I want to do it.”

Those last words came with difficulty but he forced them out anyway. Celeste nickered and looked away, the cogs in her brain clearly working as she tried to understand. Christian smiled and hid his amusement behind the careful tilt of his head. She was so cute when she was trying to work out something new.

“Is that like when unicorns have a life partner?”

“Something like that, only most in a relationship never ever have sex with anyone else.”

Her eyes widened and she thrust her muzzle into his face, questions brimming over and spilling from her lips.

“But you are so many! However can that be that you are so great in number yet with such great restraints placed upon your mating practices?”

Celeste shook herself bodily, mane and tail whipping away from her as she dislodged annoying flies.

“I guess we ‘breed’ a bit more easily than unicorns,” Christian admitted after a moment, though it felt crass to highlight what difficult unicorns had with producing offspring. “But I want to do all I can to help, my love, truly, I do.”

“I am glad of that, Christian.” She touched her nose to his, a mischievous smile twitching at her lips. “For your mares are approaching.”

He gulped and stood stock still as the stud of mares entered the clearing – seven in total. Perhaps that would turn out to be a lucky number for him after all? Christian couldn’t even laugh at his own joke.

The mares lined up with many a shared look, tails hiked and muzzles smirking as they presented themselves as if for inspection. Although none could compare to Celeste’s splendour, they all wore jewellery and harnesses of some fashion and Christian was struck by the thought that they had dressed up especially for him. It was almost as if he was going on a date with all of them at once. One even wore a cotton harness adorned with bells – wherever she got those, he would never know – that tinkled musically when she walked or tossed her finely shaped muzzle. Christian inhaled deeply and wondered how much noise they’d make when he mounted her.

Celeste, however, had chosen a simply jaw-dropping ensemble for the event and was clad in an intricate net of diamonds that ran the full length of her body. No expense had been spared for the occasion and, after learning a woman’s love of diamonds from Christian’s stories of the human world, Celeste had demanded that they be imported. Their goods to trade must have served them well as the ensemble had thusly appeared, exactly as she had envisioned it, if her prancing squeals were anything to go by. Christian worried that, when he mounted her, he would rip them from her body and render the harness useless, broken beyond hope of fixing.

Not that that would stop him – or Celeste for that matter. They would only have to be extra careful.

The mares nickered and pivoted, showing off for him and prancing on the spot as his sheath swelled in response. He ducked his head shyly and felt his upper lip curl back from his blunt teeth as he sifted through the scents – only aroused mare overpowered them all, as intoxicating as any liquor. Nickering, he stretched out his head, bobbing it anxiously, as Celeste nudged his shoulder, sides trembling with suppressed laughter.

“Do not worry yourself, Christian,” she said warmly, supporting him as he needed to be in the moment. “They all desire you. You should enjoy yourself as you will with the mares. No bad will come of this, I promise you.”

As if in agreement, one of the mares spun on the spot and backed up towards him, tail flagged and marehood clenching, pulling up in that telltale wink that he had come to know oh so well.

“Shall we begin, Christian?” The palomino, Nandag, raised her tail and presented him with her hindquarters, marehood winking flirtatiously. “We have been waiting for you for so long. You would not think to keep a lady waiting for longer, would you?”

Christian jumped, skin shivering.

“What, just like that?” He looked from left to right but no exit route was forthcoming. “Shouldn’t I, well...um...”

Nandag tilted her head, horn glowing. Christian felt rather than saw her magic wrap around him from head to hoof and drag him insistently forward, hooves scraping through the grass as he struggled. Kicking out, the stallion neighed for help but Celeste was too busy laughing, legs shaking so hard that she could barely keep her balance, to assist.

The palomino mare forced his muzzle up to her winking pussy where he was helpless to watch her cunny pull up and release a stream of juices. Her arousal drooled to the grass, extending in a long string until the point it broke and dropped gelatinously, tossing more of her hormones into the air. Christian’s nostrils flared and he thrust his nose up under her tail, tongue swiping the length of her teardrop shaped sex. It was the first he had tasted besides Celeste and the mixture of honey and tangy arousal – could mares alter their ‘taste’? – made him moan. He lapped eagerly, ears relaxing, and grunted as he tongued the mare’s clit, pushing the swelling nub until she snorted and stamped.

“It is no task for a colt to breed a mare,” she whispered, breath coming more raggedly as her sides heaved. “What are you, Christian? Are you a colt or are you a stallion?”

He snorted and shook himself.

“I am a gentleman. *And* a stallion,” he added as an afterthought, her humour bringing a smile back to his lips. “And I plan to show you exactly how I bring the two together.”

His horn glowed. Although he did not quite trust his magic yet – let alone claim to control it – he had to try. Something slipped into place within him and he concentrated harder than he ever had managed to during his magic lessons, focusing on Nandag’s gently swaying udders. He wrapped his magic around the gorgeous, mottled grey and pink teats and tugged them down, bidding them to change as a blow glow encased them. Snorting uncertainly, Nandag shifted and he flicked his tongue over her clit to calm her, eyes closing as he concentrated. It could go wrong if he didn’t, even if Celeste was there with her wider scope of magic just in case things did go a little wrong.

Slowly, Nandag’s udders separated, a second pair forming with perfect, dark teats beside the first. She huffed as they grew, tingling with sensation as Christian’s sides darkened with sweat, pouring every ounce of energy he possessed into the change. He moulded them with every drop of magic he managed to call to the touch of his mind and filled them out, making them grow larger and fuller than they would be naturally – if four udders could ever be considered natural. They swelled under his influence until Christian gasped and broke, releasing them from his magical hold and letting them drop gracefully beneath Nandag’s barrel, which shivered wonderfully.

Maybe transformation magic would, after all, end up being his forte. He tossed his head, pleased with the result, and thrust his nose beneath Nandag’s belly to lip her teats and suck one into his mouth. He played it across his tongue, admiring the smooth, hairless texture and pressed his tongue into the tiny indent at the tip where milk would be released for a hungry foal. The mottled pink and grey colouration had changed slightly so that two of the udders

were pink and the others grey but it suited her perfectly. The stallion near enough puffed up with pride. He'd done magic! And it hadn't gone terribly wrong?

The mare snorted and groaned as his lips and tongue worked over her udders, pulling at them until she could bear no more. Watching every nuance of their liaison, Celeste nickered her encouragement, tail hiked up.

"Quell your games and breed me!" Nandag grunted, tail pushed off to the side. "You are not holding up your side of the 'deal', stallion."

Grinning, Christian withdrew his head from beneath her stomach, sparing one last lick for her aching teats. She almost regretted the loss of sensation but it was quickly replaced by the weight of the stallion upon her back. Christian grunted and thrust wildly, cock bobbing and slapping his belly. He hadn't even realised he was hard, so intently had he focused on transforming one small part of her body. Nevertheless, Christian persevered and groaned as the tip of his cock caught in her winking pussy.

It dragged him in, muscles clenching to claim her hot length of stallion meat. Christian groaned and obliged her – oh, it was so easy to oblige her. Gripping her with his forelegs, he nipped at the base of her mane where it broke over her withers and thrust with the full strength of his body, pushing in past the medial ring. The fat length forced its way in slickly, the mare's arousal making it a simple task to spread her wide. Nickered, Nandag braced herself and rocked back to her stallion, grinding her rump into his thrusts as he panted and tried to keep up.

There was no escape from a mare in need.

Udders swinging, Nandag threw her head back and cried out incoherently. Celeste watched him intently and he held her gaze, lips parted as he thrust and thrust and thrust, each studly ram pushing him ever closer to climax. There was little need to hold back when he had a whole stud of mares waiting for him – waiting for him to breed them. It seemed silly now that he had been so cautious of offending Celeste as the unicorn mare turned and showed off her drooling marehood. Before his eyes, she lifted her tail and released a stream of urine to splash across and soak into the grass, signalling her open readiness to mate. She kept her tail high as he grunted, top lip lifting from his teeth as he took in her scent, potent in the air between them. Celeste smirked, horn glowing as she teased and fondled her own multiple udders with magic, driving him to greater heights of visual pleasure.

I'm next, she seemed to silently say. And he would oblige her in a heartbeat, anything for his mare, his one and only.

Perhaps to consider her his one and only was a strange thought to have when he was balls deep in another unicorn yet it had never rung truer. He nipped Nandag's withers as he grew closer, squeezing in every last inch he could and scooting his hooves closer to put more power into his thrusts. The mare's breathing grew laboured and she whinnied as he thrust her over the edge, her whole body shuddering in a climax that had stars exploding behind lowered eyelids.

She swayed and gasped as his thrusts sped up, the stallion driving on and on and on until he joined her in orgasm with a squeal that was not all that masculine but conveyed his playful

victory all the same. He trembled and ground in as deep as he possibly could, balls tightening up between his hind legs as he spilled his seed, hopefully to sire a foal in her belly. It was difficult to keep track of the greater purpose with such a sexy mare – there was simply no other word for her – under him.

He dismounted reluctantly, cock drooping and softening as Nandag shot him a look, eyes bleary as they refocused. Her legs were splayed slightly and she brought her head down with a sigh that rippled through her whole body.

“Well...” She paused, catching her breath with flared nostrils. “I cannot say I was expecting something of that nature.”

She craned her head to look at her udders, which remained as four even through mating, and whinnied, bouncing on her hooves. Christian hoped she was pleased with them but didn’t have time to ask as a second mare, darting ahead of the others as they moved in as one herd, slid to a neat halt before his nose, haunches tucked neatly beneath her.

The unicorn flicked her black mane carefully out of her eyes with a sliver of green magic and smiled warmly, her eyes matching the colour of the magic she had chosen to use. Her coat was jet black but spotted all over with white ovals, as brilliant as a starry night. Although her mane and tail were thinner than those belonging to most of the unicorns Christian had seen, they were groomed to a silky sheen and entwined with wildflowers. She wore no jewellery but her natural adornments and, as his jaw grew slack, she cast a web of magic about her body, letting it dance and shimmer as if she was wearing an ever changing harness of the finest, rarest gemstones in every shade imaginable under the sun. The appaloosa unicorn tossed her head proudly. She could wear whatever finery she desired as long as she had her magic at her disposal.

“Christian, such a pleasure to finally meet you.” The mare dropped a kiss on his cheek, breath warm and thick eyelashes fluttering. “I am Innis. Shall we begin? I have watched you for so long, even in the castle walls.”

Her eyes held a glimmer of mischief as she turned to present her hindquarters, tail lifted invitingly.

“You and Celeste make the most delightful grunts when you are mating.”

Christian huffed and eyed her, though there was a smile behind his mock-stern look.

“Another watcher? I thought we had gathered quite a crowd already but you’re one more for the list of voyeurs, Innis.” He snorted softly as he pushed his muzzle beneath her tail and swiped his tongue over her sweetly winking marehood, grey folds pulling up. “Let me just recover, okay? I’ll take care of you in the meantime, if my sweet mare has no objections.”

“I do object, Christian.”

Celeste barrelled him backwards, shoving her head into his chest. He nickered as Innis’ marehood pulled away from him, though she still winked and released a stream of her juices as he was ‘stallion-handled’ (well, he could hardly say manhandled any longer). Innis winked

cruelly as he was dragged away, a very familiar unicorn's horn smacking into his cheek hard enough to make his ears slip back from the flash of pain. Celeste's eyes were steely.

"You are here to mate," she chastised him, pulling a vial from her cotton bag. "This is the reason we have brought so many potions with us – so that you do not need to rest between mating each mare. Time is of the essence and I am confident they will welcome your attentions on another date, perhaps one at a time." Celeste giggled, a tickle of humour returning quickly to her tone. "Although I am sure we are all vying for your attentions today."

Celeste grinned and Christian's ears pricked of their own accord, swivelling to catch the murmurs amongst the mares. He chanced that they were excited and his cock almost hardened again at the thought, yet remained obstinately soft, hanging beneath the barrel of his body in an arc that curved gently downward. Celeste shook the vial in front of his muzzle and bopped him playfully on the nose.

"Head back, stud."

Something in his chest fluttered and he tilted his nose up as she held the vial high to pour it into his waiting mouth. Gulping down every drop, Christian wrinkled his nose at the taste and moved as if to nuzzle beneath Innis' tail once again. Surely it would take a moment for the potion to kick in and he could spend a little time lapping her cunny and perhaps even her udders? Just a little time?

Yet the effect was instantaneous and Christian's eyes shot wide, the stallion tipping back on to his hind hooves. His cock swelled, growing and growing – beyond its normal size. His front hooves dropped back to the ground and he rolled his head as he struggled to comprehend what was happening. His skin tingled as if encased in a viscous, changing substance – like those weird refreshing hand gels from the supermarket – and he nickered, voice taking on a deeper tone. His cock throbbed and spurted a globule of pre cum to splatter between his forelegs. He started, jumping and groaning. Even his range had increased. Just what was the potion? Celeste brushed his cheek with her nose, evidently pleased with the results.

"Celeste..." He groaned, rocking from side to side. "What is this? It feels... Why am I bigger? How long will this last?"

Celeste nuzzled his neck, pushing his mane off the crest to the other side.

"Long enough to sire a herd of foals. And there are more vials, Christian, as many as are needed. Have no fear, for I am here to support you to our success."

With that, Christian barely whipped around in time, cock bouncing, to mount the waiting Innis. The mare squealed and lifted a hind hoof in surprised protest as he landed heavily on her back but her annoyance was swiftly quelled when his cock sank home in her winking marehood. Christian rammed deep, spreading her wide around his fatter length, and Innis stamped, hindquarters rocking as she threatened to buck. He grunted, balls slapping the curve of flesh arcing between her muscular hind legs, and drove in with wild abandon, the potion forcing him to lose himself in the moment. He bred her like the strong mare she was, driving in with confidence that she would be able to take him. Innis, shaking pleasurably, had no choice but to hold firm against his thrusts and let the stud breed her.

As Innis cried out for more, he neighed and ejaculated within her, cock sending out thick spurts of cum. He felt them travelling up his length and, through the haze of orgasm, wondered how on earth it was possible to be so productive and still standing. In any normal state, he should have collapsed out of sheer exhaustion. Yet with the potion, he felt no such tiredness. Instead, as he slipped backwards off Innis and cheekily shoved his nose into her winking, messy marehood. Oh, she was so delicious – too delicious to resist! He lapped up the creampie with relish and tongued her clit as the mixture of their sexual juices splattered his nose, pushed out with every needy wink. Her pussy pulled up repeatedly, squeezing around an imaginary cock, but Celeste had barely nudged his flank to chivvy him along when the mare squealed out her climax.

Christian only pulled away when she came down from her shuddering high, a cockier grin gracing his lips. Well, he never would be one to leave a mare needy, would he? Celeste shook her head.

“My turn, stallion.”

Instead of presenting him with her rump, Celeste’s forelegs buckled and she dropped to the grass, rolling on to her back. Although the position was more difficult to maintain, Christian appreciated the view of her udders as he gently lowered himself on top of her, nudging his knees into the crook between her forelegs and her chest to keep himself in place. Aim did not come so easily but Christian smirked, calling on his magic once more.

As he sank in, the head of his cock catching and flaring, he poured his magic into Celeste’s udders, making the gorgeous, pink mounds swell. Slowly, horn aching, he added an additional pair, pulling the teats up and out with more confidence after practicing with Nandag. The soft, fleshy udders squashed down slightly under the weight of gravity and he ached to take her teats between her lips, suckling each until Celeste squirmed and climaxed from that stimulation alone. Slamming in, Christian snorted, a fierce half-grin tugging at his lips. Celeste groaned.

Transformation magic was indeed a wonderful thing.

Enjoying his mare with her extra additions, Christian powered into her with the full force of a stallion in need, hooves scraping as he used his hindquarters to buck into Celeste. He could not drive in as powerfully as he wished to but it was more than enough to send the need in his loins rising quickly, whereas the mare beneath him twisted and squealed, enduring his thrusts as each and every one drove her towards an explosive orgasm. The angle, for her was perfect, and her head rolled back against the turf as she was bred, nostrils flared and eyes half-closed in sheer, unadulterated need.

Celeste climaxed quickly and whinnied, the sound cutting off as she threw her head back, throat elongated and quivering. Christian nipped it lovingly, shuddering through his own climax as he emptied his balls, cock twitching and throbbing as if it suddenly had a life of its own. But it didn’t seem like anything was going to slow his rampant string of breeding as Celeste, although tired, snatched another vial from her bag – too quickly for him to protest. She pushed it into the corner of his mouth and upended it with a twinkle in her eye, forcing the mixture down his throat. His softening cock jumped back to full mast and Christian groaned, ears flicking as he pulled out with a wet slurp of sexual juices, a messy creampie

trickling over her lips as she winked and pushed out more of their mixed fluids, a creamy combination. Christian licked his lips, fighting not to lean in. It was clear that the potions made him over productive also, if the remnants of ejaculation were anything to go by, drooling out of the needy mares.

When Celeste was spent, at least for the moment, he had three other mares lined up waiting for his attention. Madisyn, Marsaili, Alina and Aisling presented themselves side by side, tails flagged and waving like flags in the breeze. Christian froze, cock bobbing, as Celeste nickered, encouraging him on. But who to choose?

Well, they would all have to be bred one at a time, of course!

Bounding towards the speckled fleabitten grey Marsaili, Christian leapt heavily on to her back, hooves scrabbling in the dirt. She was bare of any jewellery and grunted softly as she took his weight, though made no complaint other than to spread her hooves apart to support him better for the mating that was to come. The mare rocked back into his thrusts, taking every inch as Christian let go of any inhibitions remaining, balls slapping as he thrust and thrust until his legs shook and another vial was suddenly between his lips, bidding him to drink and continue, always continue.

He took each mare in turn, admiring and manipulating their bodies with magic as he willed. It was especially pleasing, after he had mated several times and was finally taking Alina with the aid of Celeste's potions, to force magic into his shaft, making it grow. Alina snapped and stamped as his cock grew larger within her, words that he would never have thought fitting for a unicorn spilling dirtily from her legs. Snatching her mane up between his teeth, he hammered into her pussy, spreading her tightness, and filled her with every drop he could from his magically replenishing balls. He knew with an innate sense of smugness that Alina for certain would be sore come morning. He'd leave his mark with her like he would leave his foal.

Christian stood in a circle of mares, senses overcome with the scent of well bred unicorns, marehoods pointed towards him and winking, tugging up and down in that traditional, needy fashion. It was impossible to focus on any one for all were so beautiful to him. He spun on the spot, nostrils flared and pupils dilated. He had bred all of them, surely he had. But who was next? There had to be another mare in need of mating, there simply had to be. Christian looked desperately to Celeste and chuffed softly, wantonly. He couldn't be done yet!

But only one filly remained. The youngest of the group – and the one that Christian suspected had never before mated – hung back, ears flicking uncertainly. Celeste could not fail to notice her hesitated and approached her with a kind eye. Although there was a little size difference between them, there was no question that the filly was growing into herself and was absolutely sexually mature and ready to mate, despite her mental hesitation. Her body moved without her will and she flagged her tail, wanting the stallion even if she held herself away, a nervous nicker on her lips.

“Karin,” Celeste teased, tail swishing. “Are you so shy? You have been asking after Christian for many moons now. You cannot tell me that you are no longer interested in being bred.”

The white filly squeaked and hid behind her mane, letting the silky curtain tip across her cheek and face as she ducked her head right down to the ground.

“No...” Karin’s voice was so quiet that Christian had to strain to hear, blood roaring in his ears as his cock slapped his belly. *Breed!* “I... I only have never been with a stallion before.” She gulped, refusing to look up. “I do not know how I should behave.”

“Oh, Karin.”

Celeste pressed herself to the filly’s side and lifted her head, gently tucking her horn beneath Karin’s chin. She looked her in the eyes the best she could, turning her head back and forth slightly to allow her to take in the filly fully. Christian snorted and danced, holding himself back. He didn’t have to mate with Karin if she didn’t want him to but the magical potion seared through his veins like liquid fire and his shaft refused to soften. He could take another mare, whoever wanted him, if she did not desire his mating spire any more. One would never be forced with him, although he could not say that a twinge of disappointment did not tug at his heart.

Celeste touched her nose to Karin’s.

“There is no set way to behave,” she said. “You can act however you want to.”

Karin eyed Celeste doubtfully, tail twitching.

“Come,” the older, wiser mare added with a sultry wink and flick of her tail. “Allow me to show you the ways of marehood.”

Celeste winked and put her head close to Karin’s as if confiding a secret held close to her heart.

“Mimic me and I will show you how to make a stallion desire you so terribly that he will do anything to mount you.”

Christian didn’t think he needed any encouragement whatsoever to mount a mare but those thoughts were chased away as Celeste folded her forelegs beneath his stomach, lips nuzzling his flexing shaft. His stomach muscles contracted, bouncing the length up against his flank, and he groaned as she parted her lips and suckled the tip of his cock into her mouth, carefully to tuck her teeth away. The stallion stomped and tossed his head, fighting to stay still. Oh, he had not felt anything like that since... Well, not since he had been human.

Huffing warm breath over his shaft, Celeste pushed her muzzle down carefully, lightly scraping flesh with teeth. He held firm, ears pricked to attention, and rocked gently into her embrace, moaning at the sensation of her wide, fleshy tongue nuzzled up to the underside of his cock. Karin hung back, anxiously twitching her tail. It was shorter than Celeste’s and her body was completely devoid of any jewellery but she was perfect like that. It made her somehow all the purer and more natural – untainted – for coming as she was, in nothing but her white coat. Snorting, Christian shook a hind hoof, needing to release the tension somehow as his mare teased his cock with her lips and tongue, suckling at the tip.

“Join me,” Celeste whispered, her voice silken sweet. “I will show you, Karin. Have no fear. You are bolder than I as a filly.”

Karin took one step forward and then another, head close to the grass. She copied Celeste and bent her forelegs, slipping down to lay on the grass with her legs tucked to one side. The position gave Christian the perfect view of her virgin marehood, so small in comparison to the other mares. Perhaps it was that she was naturally smaller in stature and, although able to mate, still growing into herself with a hint of lanky yearling about her limbs. But it was that long-leggedness that gave her an elegance that he had only ever seen Celeste exceed.

Tentatively, as if something was going to jump out and frighten her, the filly brushed her nose over Christian's shaft – what was not covered by Celeste's skilled, sucking lips and muzzle. She shuddered and stuck her tongue out to lick, a drop of wetness that made the stallion above her tremble. It was unskilled and brief and everything he had ever wanted.

Emboldened by her first taste, Karin lapped over his length as Celeste sucked, making her way down past his medial ring to his grapefruit sized balls. They had shrank some after his mating with Alina, during which he'd enlarged both his testicles and shaft for her pleasure, but seemed more than enough to make the filly moan in need and awe. Christian would have puffed up with pride if he had not been so distracted. The filly tongued his balls, covering every inch in a light coating of saliva as she explored his body, marehood winking the whole time.

Christian was treated to a near perfect view of her tight opening flexing, pulling down and open for him, as her body took over and pushed out a thick dollop of her arousal. Karin did not seem to notice and continued licked and suckling at his balls and underside of his shaft as Celeste murmured encouragement, guiding her gently to the head. The filly's lips covered his flat tip and Christian nearly came right then and there, front hooves lifting from the grass as need roared through his body.

His hindquarters shuddered and he bucked forward, forcing a few inches accidentally into Karin's surprised muzzle. Though her lips and teeth caught him uncomfortably, his eyes rolled back into his skull: *heaven*. Christian whickered, the sound deep and guttural. It was enough to make any mare weak at the knees. Karin winked again in response, pink and grey lips gleaming with moisture. She was ready.

"I think you have teased your stud enough, Karin," Celeste giggled, eyes sparkling as she eased out from underneath Christian. "Come now."

When Celeste got to her hooves, there were grass stains on her knees and her jewellery was askew but Christian's heart still leapt at the sight of her. There could never be a creature as beautiful as his mare, his unicorn, his Celeste. Karin scrambled after Celeste, half-tumbling over her own hooves in her haste and Celeste chuckled, touching her cheek to the arch of Karin's neck.

"It is time."

Karin whinnied and visibly gulped, eyes so wide that they nearly bulged out of their sockets. Celeste nudged her around until her hindquarters pointed towards Christian, her little tail – which only reached her hocks – twitching with a mind of its own. Unsure if the filly was consciously shifting, restlessness seeping through every motion, Christian brushed his lips over her back, eyes dark with desire. He wasn't confident that he was being very reassuring,

pent up on potions, and it was lucky that he had Celeste there to fulfil that role in the moment.

The unicorn touched her horn to Karin's, noses a hair's breadth apart as they shared breath.

"Take it slow, Christian."

The stallion's ears twitched back in protest. But he hadn't had to take it slow with any of the other mares! He stomped, indignant, and struggled to quell the part of him that was thinking purely with his downstairs brain. The potions Celeste had dropped down his throat didn't just affect his virility, it seemed, as he wanted to breed and breed and breed – everything over again – without pause for rest. He had more to give and Karin *would* take it. Only slowly. Christian dropped his head and lipped gently at her rump, giving her an awkward smile as she glanced back at him.

"Don't worry," he said, tongue thick in his mouth. "I'll be gentle. As gentle as I can be. And Celeste will be here for you, right here."

Though the filly closed her eyes and her nostrils flared, she made no protest and held her head high as she flicked her tail up out of the way. Her marehood clenched, pushing out a thick flow of clear juices, winking like the older mares. He was sure she did not know how alluring the motion was and he thrust his nose under her tail, pushing his tongue into her vent and snorting hot air. The filly squealed and half-bucked, hind legs rising up against his chest, but Christian barely noticed. His vision – what he could see in front of his nose – was encompassed by her taut, white-coated hindquarters and the twitching pink of her sex, dragging around his tongue as she continued to wink, wanting him, needing him.

Karin moaned and braced her legs, ears splayed as her marehood winked again, pulling up just as she released a hot stream of urine. It splashed down between her hind hooves and seeped into the earth, though not before her hormones flooded the air. Christian's lip curled up instinctively but he couldn't bring himself to pull away from her marehood, slammed with the full force of her scent. Karin groaned as she presented, the stream tapering off slowly, and peered back pleadingly, giving a little desperate toss of her head. Her marehood winked repeatedly, a twitch of her body that was beyond physical control when she was in such a sheer state of need. Pulling his head back, the stallion inhaled her scent greedily, lungs working in short, sharp breaths to take her into him, her winking, dripping marehood capturing his eyes. His cock bobbed against his belly, muscles flexing unconsciously, and Christian licked his lips, tasting her on him.

She was ready.

As Celeste brought her lips to the filly's, soothing her in a long, deep, passionate kiss that almost had Christian pausing to watch, the stallion ever so gently lowered his weight on to Karin's hindquarters. The filly grunted, the sound muffled by his lover's lips, and Christian lipped softly at the back of her neck, mussing up her mane. He hoped she'd enjoy every second of her first mating, for he would do everything he could to make it a pleasant one. Unicorns were resilient – he hadn't hurt Celeste their first time, after all, even with the unicorn demanding he be roughed, harder, faster with her. Groaning, Christian's sides trembled and he slipped his forelegs down around her side, pulling her to him as his shaft slid over her rump.

Panting, Karin's head rolled back, breaking the kiss with Celeste, and the mare pressed her cheek to hers. Celeste's eyes locked with Christian's and he started to see the dark, burning need flaring within, the mare's tail held high as she supported the filly.

Now, she seemed to say. He could only hope he was reading her correctly but his stallion side could not be held back with a mare beneath him. His hips moved of their own accord and he squealed as he sought out his prize, jabbing at the filly, who was a little smaller than those he'd previously bred, to leave trails of creamy pre cum slithered over her perfectly white coat. Steadying himself the best he could, Christian grabbed a chunk of mane between his teeth, teeth just barely scraping the arch of her neck in his haste.

When his cock brushed her marehood and he felt it wink against his tip – the most *delicious* sensation! – he knew he had her. Thrusting, he sank into her folds and took the filly's virginity, sliding deep and deeper as she trembled beneath him. Brushing Karin's cheek with her lips, Celeste captured her lips again, murmuring to her between lustful kisses how well she was doing and how good it was going to feel. Shuddering, the filly visibly relaxed, tension slipping from her withers and her tunnel squeezed around the stallion, so tight already, begging him deeper.

Satisfied that she was becoming quickly accustomed to his length, Christian eased in, scooting his hind hooves closer to her rump rather than slamming inside in one, brutal thrust. The other mares may have liked that but he thought the filly may have taken a few moments more to really stand up to that kind of breeding. Groaning, Karin rocked back into him, tongue pushing back against Celeste's as their kiss grew wet and wanton. With his medial ring barely outside her twitching folds, moving in the imitation of a wink with his cock spreading them wide, Christian paused.

He called on his magic, balls deep in the filly. There couldn't have been a more perfect time and, if he was honest with himself, her pure white coat and cute, pink nose reminded him so much of Celeste that he saw her in his mind's eye as the young Celeste he had never seen. Truly – they could have been sisters. Nuzzling Karin's neck, Christian breathed her in, sliding back and forth gently within her as she moaned, legs trembling so terribly that he was afraid she would topple over. But Celeste was there to make sure she did not. He was already half over head over heels in...well, maybe close to love or the kindling of such matters of the heart, at least. Christian's ears twitched as he wrapped his magic around Karin's udders, applying a little pressure to squeeze and massage them: the filly grunted.

Concentrating, Christian's neck darkened with sweat in a line down the muscle and he focused on adding another pair of udders to the filly's neat little pair. Soft and pink, they swelled into the touch of magic and he would have said that her body almost eagerly leapt to him, begging to be changed. There was no resistance from her as he poured magic into her udders and teats, making them larger and fleshier than before. She whickered into Celeste's muzzle and shuffled her hind hooves apart as he worked his magic, letting their natural colour come into play as, in a stroke of daring, he moulded them into not four but six pairs of udders. She was so like Celeste that he had a feeling she may like the alteration as much as his mare, although it was only as temporary or permanent as she wanted it to be. Christian did not think he could ever bring himself to do something to the filly, or Celeste either, for that matter, that she did not desire.

Finishing off his work, Christian let her fuller udders drop lightly beneath her stomach, swinging as he pulled back and ground lightly deeper, exploring fresh depths of her sweetness. Celeste broke the kiss and giggled musically, the sound shattering the unspoken tension that had grown between the three of them. Exhaling a sigh that Christian had not know he had held through the course of transforming Karin's udders, the stallion chuckled with her. Sex could not be so serious! And his magic could do things he never had thought were possible!

And he had a gorgeous filly under him. What could be better?

"These truly are beautiful, Christian," Celeste murmured, dipping her muzzle beneath Karin's stomach to lip and nuzzle at the filly's additional teats – sparing a tease for the others as well. "Who would have thought that your magical prowess would have lain in transformation magic?"

She looked up at him, on the filly's back, with eyes smouldering.

"I will have to see what you are able to achieve with me."

Christian gulped, imagining what Celeste could have in mind and failing to come up with anything. It was hard to think on top of a filly, cock wrapped up in the warmth of her sex. Celeste sucked one of Karin's teats between her lips and the filly squealed, pawing unstably at the air. Christian balanced her and thrust harder, letting her feel nearly the full length of his shaft, amazed that she had been able to take so much at all.

As his mate teased the filly's teats, playing with their sensitivity, Christian lost himself in the oddest threesome he could ever have imagined having. Admiring Karin's new udders – she had to say, Christian really had outdone himself – Celeste lavished attention upon them, experimenting with how the filly reacted to light brushes of her nose in contrast to sharp yet fleeting love nips. Everything she gave the filly drank in lustfully, nostrils flaring as she could not keep her weight still, shifting as if constantly seeking out greater and greater heights of pleasure. It was all very new from her and Celeste sucked two of her teats at once, rubbing them over her tongue.

The filly squealed and stamped. She tossed her head, mane flipping into a wild mess about her head and neck, frizzing and curling adorably.

"More..."

Christian had to strain to hear her, putting his head as close to hers as he dared without overbalancing the two of them.

"Please..." She whispered, lifting her head so sharply that she almost smacked her horn into his cheek. "Please, I want you to mate me. Let me become a mare." The filly sucked in a deep breath. "Let me become a mare *today*."

Her desire was evident and, trusting that she would be able to take everything he had to give, Christian nipped her neck lovingly.

"If you insist, my sweet."

Pulling back, he gripped her sides more firmly with his forelegs and dragged his cock from her marehood with a slurp of juices. She whinnied at the loss, marehood winking as if to call him back, and neighed loudly enough to scare birds from the trees as he drove back in more roughly, slamming in up to the medial ring.

“Please!” Karin cried, holding fast beneath the stallion’s rampant thrusts, succumbing to desire. “Harder! Make me bear your foal, Christian! I want to feel your seed flooding me! Make me yours.”

She said the last line in a voice barely above a whisper and Christian gasped, wondering if he had heard her correctly at all. Though there was no time to wonder as his body commanded his actions, brain slow in the moment. He drove in to the hilt and jerked his head up, abruptly aware of the burble of exchanged words around them, so out of place with their lustful mating.

The mares, his ejaculate still leaking from their winking marehoods, had closed in without them realising, eyes bright and tails flagged. It seemed that they were enjoying the show almost as much as they were enjoying themselves. Nickering, Alina stomped a hoof and turned to show off her stretched passage, marehood winking and begging for more even as soreness tickled at her rump. Karin’s head shot up and she looked back at them with wide eyes, the faintest rim of white showing around the iris.

“Look at her,” the watching mares whispered, although the trio could not tell who was speaking. “That is a filly becoming a mare.”

“I did not stand up that well to *my* first mating.”

“She shall be as bold as the sun.”

“And as forthcoming as Celeste.”

Karin’s ears went back and she let out a loud moan that set the mares’ ears twitching as they nickered amongst each other. Alina strutted in front of the filly, tail held high like a flag, and turned her backside to her, showing off her marehood. Hind legs braced, she winked, pushing out a slick mixture of semen and mare arousal, letting it drool over her pulsing sex. It marked her grey marehood cream, a sign of their mating, and Christian kept his eyes fixed on it as he rocked into the filly, grunting as his cock ached. To be faced with so much stimulation... He shook his head. It was very nearly overwhelming.

Shuffling back, Alina pushed her rump into Karin’s muzzle, letting the filly get a good look at her overflowing cunny, winking constantly. One breeding would never be enough for the lustful Alina, as well filled as she had been. A mare had needs to be taken care of too, one had to know! The filly groaned and stretched her head forward, lipping the air as if trying to strain her neck far enough to reach Alina’s winking treat. The mare snickered and tossed her head, forelock falling in a tumbled mess over her eyes. Somehow, as dishevelled as she was, she still managed to come off as smug.

Her body rocked forward suddenly as Christian gave a particular rough thrust, speeding up. His breathing grew laboured, hot breath rolling over her crest, and Karin pushed back into

him. The stallion bottomed out inside her, the very tip of his cock kissing her inner barrier, and she groaned. If he had any more to give she would surely be split open. Alina chuckled, whirled around on light hooves and snaked her head out to drop a kiss below Karin's horn.

"You must have him enlarge his shaft for you, Karin," Alina said with a smirk, tail waving gently over her rump. "It truly is an experience... I do not believe you shall be lacking for anything if you stick with this stallion."

Karin nickered but was unable to find her tongue for a smart comment as Christian hammered into her. Her marehood ached and she was sure she would be sore come morning but she couldn't find it in herself to care. Every moment was better than the last and she tried to squeeze around his length as the stallion pounded her, her cunny sucking him in eagerly. Her body knew what to do even if her mind did not and she stamped and rolled her head, the tension in the pit of her stomach building to a crescendo. Celeste nipped a teat sharply and, before the flicker of pain could register, latched her lips around the teat and sucked hard. Karin's shriek of pleasure caught in her throat.

It was too much for a filly to bear.

Her forelegs buckled as orgasm crashed upon her, more ferocious than a summer storm slashing lightning through a thunderous sky. Her marehood clenched, her body no longer under her control, and Karin squealed, the sound ripping through the restless circle of mares. Something – she could not say what – exploded outwards, ripples of pleasure racing through her nerves with the speed of wildfire flaring through the forest, trees cracking as easily as kindling. Her eyes closed of their own accord and her squeals turned into a low, throaty chuffing as the pleasure kept coming in waves, one after the other and each one more powerful than the last. She whinnied, throat hoarse. Would it never end? Did she want it to end?

She swayed on her hooves, mind overcome with ecstasy, and Celeste quickly pushed herself further beneath the filly's belly to keep her on her hooves, keeping her weight up and trusting Christian to balance them. Celeste lapped her teats and nuzzled her udders, sending her shivering into a warming afterglow, legs weak and supported by the older, more knowing mare beneath her. She just couldn't see Celeste's smirk of pride and knowing. She'd been there too.

Christian thrust, breath raking through his throat. A spot of blood appeared in his nostril and he inhaled the metallic scent, the tight marehood around his length getting even tighter as she climaxed. It was as if his shaft had gotten larger, so great was the difference, and he had to catch himself for a moment, checking that he had not inadvertently let his magic go and manipulate his own body without realising. But no, it was only his sweet, lustful filly experiencing her first true orgasm from her first mating. Only she couldn't say she was a virgin any more.

His orgasm, when it came, was stronger than any he had had that day – regardless of the fact that he had run dry on the potions and had drunk nothing for his last two mating sessions. Thrusting through a series of low, satisfied grunts, Christian felt his balls pull up slightly closer to his body – the sensation was greater than the appearance, pulling tighter and tighter and tighter until the tension had to be expended somehow. He rammed in and neighed as he spilled his seed, cock jerking and twitching within the mare, tail flagged up high and proud.

Karin moaned quietly, ears drooping as she pulled as much strength into her legs as she could with her energy at an all time low. All in all, there was one thing she had certainly learned from the experience as Christian's throbbing shaft filled her to the brim: breeding was hard work.

But good hard work. Very good. Her tongue lolled from between her lips as she panted open-mouthed.

Easing from beneath the filly, Celeste left her with a parting kiss dropped on each of her teats

"You and I appear the same now," she said proudly, turning so she was side-on to the filly and able to show off her own swollen udders. "It is a look you show off well, dear Karin."

"T-thank you?"

It was the only thing Karin could think of to say but it seemed to do the trick. Celeste snorted and brushed her lips over Karin's cheek as Christian dismounted, cock drooping spent below his stomach. He dropped his head, exhausting trembling through the line of his body.

"You did well, sweet filly, for your first time," she breathed. "It becomes even more wonderful, I promise. You shall desire more and more of this, breeding and allowing your body to experience such pleasure. It is truly an experience that no mare should be denied."

Celeste made as if to present her hindquarters to Christian, tail already raised in invitation – or demand, depending on how one looked at it – but paused halfway through the motion. She darted for him, concern flashing across her expression in the slight but noticeable narrowing of her violet eyes.

"Christian." Celeste bumped her nose into his cheek, drawing his attention. "You are over exerting yourself. Please, quickly – drink this."

She held a vial – the last from the little cotton bag – in front of his muzzle. Although his eyelids drooped, he obediently took it between his lips and gave a little flick of his head to toss the liquid up and straight down his throat. Instantly, energy returned to his limbs, beginning as a warm sensation spreading up from his hooves to the bulk of his body. He sighed and shook himself, soft cock retreating to his sheath and brightness flickering back into his eyes.

"Sorry," he chuckled, kissing his love briefly. "That one really took it out of me."

"I am only glad to see you looking a little better, Christian, although I fear you may have drained our little filly here absolutely."

Karin dropped her forelegs and slipped to the ground on her side, blinking blearily. Her tail flicked over her hindquarters, semen leaking from her marehood. Though she still winked, there was a tiredness to the muscle reflex, her body wanting more even as it trembled with exhaustion. The filly could not do more even though she wanted to, marehood twitching and pulling up. One breeding could not be enough – there had to be more. Karin looked up at the white stallion and mare looming over her and nickered softly, her top lip quivering. As she tried to reassure them that she was okay, her marehood flexed again, forcing out a thick

dollop of their combined fluids. It ran down her shiny lips and tickled her clitoris, eventually trailing a path down the very top of her hind leg. It would eventually drip on to the grass but, by that time, sleep would have already claimed her as she dripped with evidence of their tryst. She knew as much as she pushed out, however, there would be plenty left behind to ensure a foal grew in her belly. A sleepy smile flitted across her muzzle.

“I need to rest a while,” she mumbled, muzzle lowering slowly but surely to the grass. “Only a little while.”

“You sleep there, filly,” Christian murmured, sharing a quick kiss as her eyes closed. “You have performed admirably for the survival of the herd.”

“In no time at all, there will be a foal dancing between your hooves,” Celeste added, pushing a scrap of the filly’s mane back over to the side of her neck where the bulk of it lay. “For now, rest and dream. We shall ensure you make it safely home once you have regained your strength.”

Christian’s heart warmed as he watched the filly doze, ears twitching in sleep. She kicked her hind legs out to the side, forelegs tucked beneath her body, as if to put her udders on show. He admired them, one with a splotch of grey that had not been present before that he found especially endearing. Although she looked so much like Celeste, he could not deny the differences between them and it was those differences that had him more and more sinking under her spell. The stallion’s gaze grew hazy as he dreamed for a moment, seeing a life ahead where Celeste and Karin were both at his side. Celeste grazed his gaze and smiled, showing off her winking marehood, gleaming alluring in the late afternoon dapples of sunshine. The day had worn on but she wasn’t done with him either and would have him on her back at least once more before their mass mating session was over.

Yes, he’d be quite happy to spend many more years with the filly as she grew and learned and became a fine mare at his side. The stallion dipped his muzzle, letting the potion rejuvenate him even as his mind thought he should be sleeping, that he should be tired still. It was an artificial energy, the potion, and he wondered if he would sleep for days after the event as a result. The mares crowded close as Celeste nuzzled Karin, keeping watch as the younger unicorn recovered her strength.

Hauling himself tiredly to his hooves as Alina flagged her tail, frizzing hair giving the pretence of concealing her marehood from view. His eyes locked on to her puffy slit, watching it pull up and down, squeezing out a stream of clear arousal to , tinged with a sliver of his creamy seed. Not much of his seed escaped her, however, and he watched, transfixed, as her grey cunny squeezed and flexed as if begging him in once more. His cock rose to half-mast below his stomach and he nickered, the sound deep and guttural as his eyes dropped to her swinging udders. They were just the two and he reached for his magical, tendrils flickering deep within his mind, playfully welcoming him back. Now that he knew where to find his magic, that locked up box within his mind, it felt like an old friend and an easier feat to wrap the mental glow around his horn, only to cast it forth to manipulate another transformation.

Alina snorted, head lowered, as her udders tingled, the very beginning. He may even give her six udders in total just like Celeste and Karin. It suited them perfectly, so why not Alina? He could spread his magic around now that he knew how. And the mares could always change it

back if they wanted to – it wasn't permanent, not by any means. Christian grunted, shaft hard and ready even without the aid of potions, instinctively going up on to his back hooves as she winked with the flirtatious edge of a seasoned mare. She knew how to entice a stallion in and Christian did not yet know – or want – to resist.

As he planted his weight once more upon the beautiful mare's back, his ears flushed pink at the memory of Karin. Her warmth was still on his cock as he sank it into Alina, the mare huffed and grinding back to meet him. As he watched Celeste tending to the filly, out of the corner of his eye, with a softness she rarely revealed, something told him that he'd be seeing a lot more of that not so little one.

And he wouldn't be minding that at all.

*

Karin continued to follow Christian around the village during the course of the days after his group mating session, although she no longer kept her distance. Celeste assured him that she did not object to her presence and even took advantage of being observed, stopping in the centre of the village with her cunny winking and demanding that he breed her. Christian wasn't in a position to argue and mounted her eagerly every time, filling her with all the seed he had, tail twitching as he ejaculated. Karin watched intently and, after some cajoling, joined them in mating, teasing Christian's cock with her lips and tongue until he put his weight over her hindquarters and bred her until her legs shook.

Christian could not get the filly out of his head as he trotted through the village late one night, sleeplessness at his hooves. How long would it take for his foals to be born? Surely some of the mares should have caught by now? There was no way of telling until they started to show and the wait was nerve wracking. He could not help but think that all his efforts would bring more stallions into the herd too late to help anything and they would all be doomed regardless. Nothing would have made any difference and everything would have been naught. He snorted and lowered his head, mental darkness trapping him like a vice.

He started as a white shape ghosted in front of him from behind a shelter, shivering through the darkness. The stallion's heart pounded.

"Karin!" He admonished, trying to keep his tone steady. "What are you doing here? You scared me nearly half to death."

The filly smiled sweetly, ears twitching.

"I wouldn't have thought that you could be scared, Christian."

She turned and presented, showing off her multiple udders and fat, heavy teats, gravity pulling them down towards the ground. Her pussy, spotted with the tiniest flecks of grey within the soft, petal-perfect pink, winked and pulled up as if to draw him in through its visual effect along. He stared, hypnotised, and bobbed his head, cock dropping instantly. The filly just had that effect on him.

She nickered softly, eyes bright.

“Mount me!”

A hint of Celeste rang through her words – clearly she had taken the older mare’s teachings to heart – and he obediently mounted her, feeling her rock and steady herself beneath him. But she had started it and, by the stars above, he was going to finish it and fill her up. He felt a twinge of unease – he’d never mated another mare without Celeste being there – and imagined his sweetheart watching from the shadows, awaiting the opportune moment in which to dart out and demand to be bred, eyes burning like embers in the night.

The filly grunted as his flat cock-tip pressed to her winking cunny, sliding slickly through her juices. Christian groaned. She was soaked, her marehood squeezing out her arousal as she flexed eagerly, opening herself for him. Taking the invitation, he pushed in and lost himself in the breeding, grinding deeper and deeper. His shaft stretched out her young tunnel and he eagerly poured his magic into his length and balls, using it to take the place of Celeste’s potions and give the filly as much pleasure as possible. His orbs swelled, impossible virile, and his length gently widened her passage, the very tip kissing her cervix. Eyes rolling back into her head, Karin groaned and begged to be bred. He was only too happy to oblige.

Beneath the moonlight, their bodies became one and Christian spilled his seed within her. He doubted that it would be the last time and his heart warmed at the thought of spending more time with the filly. Her sweet nature made her irresistibly sexy and, by the gods, he was sure she knew it. She had a hold on him and she damn well knew it too.

When he ejaculated, he hit her withers, teeth digging in hard enough to scuff through her coat and leave a bruise on the skin. He feared she would kick out at the bite – merely a love nip – but her moans grew louder as she climaxed on his length, marehood tightening to such an extent that he feared he would never be able to pull out again, so fierce was the grip of her body on his magically enlarged shaft.

The stallion nickered and rolled his head, releasing her withers and working his jaw, exhaustion drowning him as if someone had upended a bucket over his head. He bet the filly would have loved that. A stallion to breed her forever, trapped in her twitching cunny while she demanded orgasm after orgasm and a foal seeded in her belly.

Dismounting, Christian let his cock slide regretfully from her beautifully winking passage and nuzzled the arch of her neck. The filly started to talk but his head shot up, eyes wide and nostrils twitching at the scent that came to him on the breeze. His cock hardened, refusing to return to its sheath. That scent was too familiar to be ignored and his heart leapt, a whinny tickling at his throat. Well, well, well, perhaps his watcher had been on the shadows after all. The filly burred on, oblivious to his sudden distraction.

“Christian, you have –”

“Wait, Karin! Karin, quiet!”

Christian hissed and pushed the filly behind him, ears pricked.

“What’s Celeste doing out?” Karin whispered, poking her head around his rump.

The stallion shook his head.

“I have no idea but...” He hesitated, the words teetering on the tip of his tongue. “But perhaps it would be wisest to find out.” He looked the filly over, expression softening. “Go home, Karin. Perhaps the morning will find us with more time to spend with one another.”

The filly’s eyes sparkled.

“You had best make that a promise!”

The filly skipped off, his seed still leaking from her winking marehood, and he shook his head. How could the filly still be horny after all that? But he had more pressing concerns to think about. Shaking his mane off his neck, he placed his hooves with utmost care, choosing spots where there were no twigs to snap or crack and announce his presence.

Whether she wanted to be followed or not, he would find out where Celeste was going.

He followed the mare at a distance, his sensitive hearing picking up the sound of her passage as she moved further and further away from the unicorn village. If he was still human, his brow would have furrowed. Just where was she going at such a time? Something fluttered in his chest. She wasn’t just out for a late night walk like he had. Something far more serious was going on as the mare stole away, hooves ghosting over the grass.

Catching sight of her as she strode across a clearing, he hung back on the edge of the trees, watching her silvery form. She crossed the clearing without looking back, ears pricked and muzzle bobbing lightly as she made her way towards her destination – although what destination she had in mind, Christian could not fathom. The stallion felt a twinge of guilt in his chest as the unicorn disappeared into the trees and he followed as quietly as a whisper on the breeze. He’d thought things were getting better within the unicorn herd. Was Celeste so worried that she’d taken to walking after dark on a regular basis? He tried not to think of what he had been out doing while his love had supposedly been wrapped up in worry. He had not known.

He did not know how long he tracked her through the forest, only that dawn touched the treetops when she finally came to a halt at a wooden structure. Upon first impressions, it appeared to be some manner of keep, not dissimilar to the speedy erecting of a motte and bailey castle, thrown together hastily as one encroached on enemy territory and defended one’s borders. It was in disrepair and the perimeter wall leaned to the inside, wooden poles straining against ropey strands of twine, which seemed to be all that was holding it together. Christian scowled. Just who had done such a terrible job of putting together a shelter? Although it was much too large to be any normal shelter.

Looking it over as his eyes adjusted to the flicker of early light, Christian gasped and shuddered backwards, afraid that Celeste would have heard, standing before what appeared to be a gate with an expectant tilt to her head. It was not a shelter – no. It was far too large for that. It was a gryphon castle. An outpost thrown together to protect them from attack while they prepared his own. His heart hammered in his chest and he strained forward, eyes bulging as his mare – Celeste! – stood in the open, completely undefended. Angling her head to tap her horn politely on the gate, she neighed loudly, horn aglow with a pale blue sheen.

A tawny gryphon popped his head up from the other side of the wall and gripped the top of the poles between his forepaws, beak parted to reveal a slice of hungry, red maw. Christian tensed, magic at the ready to leap to his love's defence. What on earth was she doing? He didn't want to trust that she knew what she was doing any more. Christian shifted his weight, weaving his head back and forth, back and forth. He wanted to get her out of there, scoop her up and away from the gryphons. Yet she must have a reason for approaching the gryphons! Trembling, Christian held fast, though every muscle screamed at him to *act*.

Eyeing the mare, the gryphon screeched and flapped, a scattering of feathers drifting down to rest at Celeste's hooves. The unicorn did not flinch.

"Who goes there?" The guard demanded, talons flashing with metal in the early morning sunlight.

"Celeste," she answered in a clear tone that rang above the rising wind.

The wind picked her mane and batted it against her neck as the gryphon looked her up and down. Christian would have said that there was a calculating look in his eye as the unicorn waited, tail still and flat against her rump, but did not know enough about gryphon-kind to claim such a fact with certainty. He tensed, leaning forward almost out of his hiding place within the trees, and stifled a whinny as the gryphon disappeared.

The gate creaked open in a shudder of sawdust and the brown gryphon reappeared on the ground, standing slightly shorter than the fully grown unicorn. He had a younger, more lopey stride as if he had not quite grown into himself and, keeping his body between Celeste and the gate, strutted back and forth. He preened, long tail swinging sinuously.

"Celeste?" He sneered, clacking his beak. "Is that all they call you?"

The unicorn lifted her head and the gryphon followed her every move, eyes as intent as those of a feline stalking its prey.

"That is correct," she replied evenly, her tone giving nothing away.

"Well, *I* am Moongleam Shattered-Feather of the. You cannot be anyone of importance if you only come before us with one name."

"One name is all that is needed."

The gryphon fluffed up his feathers and cackled, shaking his head. Celeste sighed and scraped a hoof through the bare earth, scuffing a line through it. Christian's heart beat more regularly, though with an intensity that felt as if it was trying to force its way through his chest.

"I am here to meet with Sharptalon. He is expecting me."

The gryphon's cackle cut short and he stared at the unicorn, amber eyes unblinking.

"So you are the one..."

He trailed off, shook himself and disappeared back into the stronghold. Celeste watched him go, ears twitching in the first hint of uncertainty.

“Well then?” The gryphon squawked faintly from within, out of Christian’s sight. “Are you coming or are you going to stand out there all night? Have no mind, it makes no difference to me.”

Celeste followed the gryphon inside and Christian hurled himself into an action a moment too late – the gates were already swinging closed as he shot into the shadows by the wall, sliding to a hasty stop before he smacked straight into it. He stared through the crack between the makeshift ‘doors’ as a white, blurred shape paced further away until she disappeared entirely behind a shelter. Stifling a nicker, the stallion half-reared and ducked his head back and forth, snorting as he sought entry, though none was forthcoming.

Breath coming in short, sharp flurries, he tried to keep himself under control, panic rising and forcing his mind into two distinct modes: fight or flight? Every animal possessed the instinct, only he could not, could never allow Celeste to put herself in harm’s way. He stomped. It had gone too far! He had to follow, he just had to make sure she was okay, that she knew what she was doing. She could be mad at him later for it if she wished – it would be the better option. He shivered to think she was walking willingly into the hangman’s noose, standing with his nose to the gate where the shadows enveloped his body. Celeste knew what she was doing...didn’t she?

No. He would make sure she was safe. Christian steeled himself, dredging up every last scarp of courage he possessed, knowing that there were god knows how many gryphons lurking behind the gate. Rapping his horn sharply on the post beside the wobbling gate – it really was just a pretence at a stronghold – Christian held his breath. The gryphon guard popped his head over the wall, squawked and yanked his head back, seeing no threat. Again, the stallion tapped his horn on the wall, careful to keep himself tucked in to the foot of it, knowing that, with every passing second, Celeste was further away from him. He screwed up his muzzle, heart fluttering into a panicked drum. He had to act quickly!

The gryphon muttered to himself and, after finding nothing to investigate, disappeared once again from view. Christian pressed himself against the wall just behind where the gate would open and held his breath, throwing magic over himself like a cloak. He’d seen Celeste do it many times on their little adventures together and only hoped he remembered how to complete the ‘spell’ of sorts. The air around him shimmered and he closed his eyes as the gate bumped open, catching on tussocks of grass where it did not swing on a level plane.

No squawk or warning screech came and he tentatively opened his eyes to see the gryphon stalking back and forth, gait jerky and uneven. Although the air glimmered around the stallion, he exhaled softly. So, he could conceal himself too with magic. That was useful to know. He’d really come into his magical self since that group mating session, which had, in a sense, awakened him. Though the gryphon searching for him would no doubt be less than interested in that matter. Bouncing into the air, he flapped twice and shrieked, the sound echoing through the trees. Christian’s ears rang.

“So have it!”

Twigs snapped underfoot as he stalked, leonine tail lashing.

“Who goes there? Are you ? Jared, if that is you, show yourself this instance. I’ll not have any of my guards playing hide and seek between the shadows. This is war, I tell you – war!”

The gryphon shrieked and flapped with his last words, lifting his body from the ground in a harried flurry of feathers. Directly in front of Christian, he looked through the stallion, swinging his head from left to right as if believing that, if he only looked for his foe enough times, he would find him.

Christian tensed.

It was time.

Christian dropped his shield and wrapped his magic around the gryphon’s beak before the beast even had the chance to shriek. No warning ripped itself from his throat as his eyes grew as wide as the orange disk of the rising sun, wings flapping wildly – a caged bird that knew he had no escape. Leaning in closed to the gryphon, his eyes bored into a pair of dark slits, the gryphon’s ear tufts twitching madly.

The gryphons had *his* Celeste.

“This is not a war you are going to win.”

Turning his head sharply, he neatly struck the gryphon on the side of his head with his horn. Unicorn horn was as unyielding as steel and a single blow was all it took to drop the gryphon effortlessly to the ground, unconscious. Christian averted his eyes from the unmoving body and nudged it into the foot of the wall where it would not be discovered too swiftly. If undisturbed, he warranted that the gryphon would be out cold until morning broke good and proper. Hopefully that would be all the time he needed.

Slipping through the narrowest gap he could manage, Christian pulled the gate almost closed behind him: he might need a speedy escape later. Throwing his cloaking magic back up, he walked slowly and carefully through a cluster of rough and tumble shelters. They were oddly crafted from bound together tree trunks and branches, like something a primitive human would have put together, and covered haphazardly in leaves. He thought they may have been in imitation of a roof – something to keep out the worst of the weather. It certainly didn’t seem that the gryphons were planning to stop in one place for very long, however.

Gryphons sprawled between shelters, crowding around fires and squabbling amongst one another as they gobbled down raw meat, tossing their heads back to shoot it straight down their gullets. They ate like animals, tearing off strips of bloody meat and staining their beaks as they devoured whatever scraps of carcasses they had had the good fortune to catch. Some did not even have the luxury of a fire to warm their wings and skulked in the shadows, tails flicking and eyes bright with longing. There was not always enough to go around when times were hard.

Christian moved unseen through them, keeping his distance as much as his path allowed. Although there was no trace of Celeste, the keep was not very large and it was only a matter of time before he came upon her. Or so he hoped, for he could not think any other way and still have the heart to continue on.

The largest shelter in the keep drew him in and he lowered his head, snuffing the grass – which stank of gryphon piss – as he approached. It was the obvious choice and yet his heart hammered as he made his way closer, wary of how his hooves left indents in the grass and soil behind him. Hopefully the gryphons would not be too observant in the dark with the lure of feasting at their beaks. Though he found it abnormal that they would be so active so early in the day, for dawn was slowly breaking, golden fingertips arching over the pine trees around the gryphon camp. His chest tightened. They only had so much time.

The shelter had two doors designed as if to open simultaneously, although they were too crudely cut to be of any real grandeur. Nevertheless, the effort had been made and Christian was glad of it as he pushed his nose into the gap between the doors, looking through with one eye as the other kept guard. Though he was still invisible, thanks to his magic, he didn't want to be caught unawares. He shuddered at the thought of gryphon talons slicing through his flesh as easily as a knife would cut through butter. Unicorn would be a fine treat to their palates.

The first thing that struck him about the interior of the shelter was the gold. There was gold in every corner, coins and ornaments so bright that he could not believe they would be real. And where would they have come from, in the middle of a forest? The second thing that caught him was the white flicker of a white unicorn mare standing before a green gryphon that was all too familiar. Christian's stomach chilled.

Sharptalon. The green gryphon from the lake that had almost carried him off for dinner. He would have thought that Nighthunter, the hasty male who had hastily blundered into battle with Celeste, would have been the real threat. But no, it was his sidekick, the one who followed that perched on a pile of gold with a gleam that Christian did not like one bit in his eye. Two gryphons in neutral colours that Christian did not recognise flanked him, eyes riveted on his mare as if watching for any sudden moves. She would not be able to escape if she wanted to, open for all to see without the aid of cloaking magic in the very heart of the gryphon stronghold. And it was no mystery why the gryphons were so close to their village at all.

Christian bristled, reaching for his magic before he knew what he was doing. And what was Celeste doing? The stallion's breath cut short in the middle of an inhalation. Surrounded. She was surrounded. He stood vigilant and waited.

The gryphon turned his head from side to side, inspecting the unicorn from all angles.

"*Celeste.*" Sharptalon clacked the edges of his beak together. "So good of you to join us."

"I assure you, the pleasure is all mine."

Celeste was nothing but polite, even when faced with eight – he counted all he could see – preening gryphons with gleaming talons. She looked so vulnerable standing before the throne, head defiantly high, with the beasts lined up at the foot of Sharptalon's ostentatious display. Christian suppressed a snort. Just what did he think he was playing at? He wasn't the leader of the gryphons so why did he garb himself like a king? The emerald-feathered gryphon rattled with gold, though it clanked uncomfortably and struck Christian as a cheap replica, not worthy of being called a treasure at all. Its gaudy flash contrasted sharply with

Celeste's royal jewellery and he ached all of a sudden to sweep her away from danger. He shifted back on his haunches as if to leap forward, the knight in shining armour he had always wanted to be.

But no: he had to trust her. He had to believe she knew what she was doing. Christian ground his teeth together until his jaw ached, every muscle tense. She knew the gryphons far better than he did. Perhaps she was there to send them off? They were too close to the village for comfort and the thought that they would go quietly was but a distant dream, a hope of a stallion who was once a human. His skin itched to think of the vicious birds so close to sweet Karin. Her innocence would make her an ideal target to be carried off if she crossed their path.

They would never get that far.

"So?" Sharptalon studied his reflection in a goblet, picking it up in a forepaw. "What business do you have here, Celeste? You will hardly see us off with but a casual visit."

"I would not expect such," she said calmly, "although I do ask that you not progress any further."

Sharptalon laughed, tossing the goblet away to clank and clatter over the mound of gold.

"Do you expect me to agree to that, *princess*?" He mocked, bowing forward on his forepaws as if to denote some manner of play. "Do you think it will be that easy? That you can pout your pretty little lips and all will be as it was before?"

"Something would look good between *her* lips."

Celeste tensed and the hidden stallion's jaw dropped, struck dumb.

"Pray refrain from that manner of talk," she said stiffly. "I do not care for it."

"I don't care what you don't care for."

Sharptalon leapt down from his perch and stalked up to Celeste, prodding her in the chest with his hard beak. Though she flinched, the unicorn did not budge a muscle and stood firm as he circled her, eyeing her all over like a piece of meat that was being prepared for butchering. Saliva collected in his mouth, swelling over his tongue, and he gulped, licking the edge of his beak. She would be delicious, if only he got his talons into her.

"How does it feel, Celeste," he crooned, "to be nothing but an animal? How does it feel to know that, very soon, your kind will be snuffed out forever? Not a single unicorn, not mare or foal or stallion, will remain."

"That will never come to be."

He chuckled, a raspy laugh that set Christian's skin prickling. He kept his magic just within reach as tensions rose within the shelter, Sharptalon's cronies joining him in circling Celeste. The arch of his neck grew more and more pronounced as he nudged open the doors further, too keen to keep an eye on what the gryphons were doing to be overly concerned about

unwelcome discovery. The glimmer of gold casting a haze over the walls shielded him from most of their view, luckily. Besides – they had more entertaining prey at the tips of their talons.

“Unicorns will never fall, much less from your efforts,” Celeste countered, turning so that she kept Sharptalon in front of her at all times, though her tail flicked nervously at the gryphons moving out sight. “Your lies mean nothing here.”

“Oh, but they do.”

The green gryphon kept his head low to the ground, skulking around Celeste in ever decreasing circles. Soon, his feathers brushed her fetlocks as he wound himself nearly around her forelegs and she looked down disdainfully, ears flat against her skull. But she did not break. Christian’s heart swelled with admiration for his love, her bravery, and he almost forgot that the scene he was watching put her in very real danger. Celeste, however, still seemed to have a handle on everything. Maybe there was hope yet.

“But maybe you are right, Celeste,” Sharptalon paused, bringing a forepaw to his beak and tapping the underside thoughtfully. “I could be wrong. In fact, I do believe I *am* wrong.”

The flames in the fire pit danced, casting grotesque shadows across the walls as Celeste backed off, head lifted out of range of the gryphons beaks and claws. Her tail lay tight over her rump and Christian sank back on his hind legs, muscles shivering with restrained tension. He dropped his shield, pulling on magic more suitable to attacking. The area around the shelter was deserted anyway – let him be spotted. He steeled himself. Celeste was more important than maintaining concealment.

“I am wrong, Celeste, for you shall be the very last of your kind. You shall linger while your herd dies one by one, in the heart of the land of the gryphons. My kingdom shall grow while yours falls. Not that there was much of it to begin with.”

“Do you believe that I cannot extricate myself from this location?” Celeste said blandly. “You are not holding me prisoner.”

“Then consider this your decree. You will not leave.”

Sharptalon leapt for her, snapping his beak closed an inch from her throat. She only jerked her head out of the way a fraction of a second before he would have drawn blood. The gryphon pursued her, movements erratic and jerky as he backed her up against a wall. Her rump pressed to the wood and Christian fumbled for his magic, cursing as it slipped out of his grasp. Outside, a gryphon chirped, cocking his head at the strange horse outside their leader’s shelter, though Christian was too intent on regaining self-control to notice. The unicorn muttered a swear he would have hated to say aloud in Celeste’s presence and stamped, fear rising quicker than the tide.

“You may not be a pretty virgin with your mate anymore,” he hissed, “but there is so much more where that came from. There is so much more we may desecrate you with.”

Christian stiffened. How long had they been watching him? He pushed the door open further, anger seething, but the gryphons did not even notice him, bare from any magical cloak.

Sharptalon flapped, a loose feather landing on Celeste's nose. She snorted it away, horn glowing to cast up a shield. Sharptalon was unfazed and prodded it with a claw, emboldened when it did not sting or shock, only keep the unicorn behind a lightly flickering blue plane.

"You will have a cunt soft enough to take our lengths," Sharptalon continued in a low, deadly tone. "How many gryphons will it take mating with you to see tears run down that pretty little face of yours? Will you weep? Will you beg for mercy? Maybe we will even have your mate watch you taken, abused and degraded. While you watch your kind burn."

Celeste froze, ears back.

"I don't think the princess likes that," he squawked to his cronies, puffing up his chest. "Such a shame. She'll have to learn, shan't she?"

They nodded in agreement, drool gleaming at the corners of their beaks. Celeste swallowed visibly and flicked her tail, muscles quivering.

"Sharptalon." Her tone was frozen, eyes dark and fearful. "This is folly, let us have an end to it at once. Tonight. There is no reason for unicorns and gryphons to be in bad faith with one another. We could even work together – for a better future."

Sharptalon scoffed and laughed as his fellows sank into a crouch, hindquarters swaying back and forth.

"You just don't get it, do you? Stupid mare. We never intended. You coming here was nothing more than the start of the end. There never was to be any treaty – this farce of an agreement between us. There is nothing for unicorns left in this world, only death." His gaze locked on to her. "Beginning with *you*."

They surrounded her, pressing her back to the wall despite her shield. She pranced and reared, striking out against gryphons that she could not reach through her own protective wall. As long as she kept the shield up, she was trapped. To attack, she'd have to drop the shield and use different magic. Cornered, the unicorn let loose a fearful whinny that chilled Christian to his bones.

Celeste had never made that sound before. But he managed to calm himself enough to reach for his magic again and pulled it to him with a relieved nicker, letting it flood him and strengthen his body.

Quickly, quickly, quickly...

Sharptalon struck Celeste's shield, claws flashing.

"Your parents will eventually find your corpse," he cackled, flapping his wings and rocking up on to his hind legs as the unicorn swayed in the buffeting blast of air. "After we have demeaned it over and over again. Maybe they won't even be able to tell it's you."

"Get away from her!"

It was not the most fearsome battle cry but it did the trick as Christian charged into the shelter, magic at full strength and a shock of golden sparks rippling out from him. They struck the gryphons and sent them reeling, clattering into the mound of gaudy gold. Sharptalon landed on his back, legs flailing, and shrieked like a banshee as he struggled to right himself again. His fellows immediately rushed to his side but the flurry of activity had already drawn attention from outside. Gryphons clustered around the door that Christian had only just left, screeching and cawing at their trapped prey.

Christian pressed himself to Celeste's side, pulling her away from the wall as his sides heaved, a rim of white surrounding his irises.

"Christian!" For once, Celeste actually looked startled, ears back and head shaking up high. "How did you come to be here? What is –"

Christian barrelled in front of her and rose up on to his hind legs, silver hooves flashing. Hissing, Sharptalon backed away, eyeing the stallion with a worrying glint in his eye.

"Well, well, well, what do we have here?" He said slimily. "Is it, perchance, a human who believes he's a stallion?"

Christian snorted.

"That hardly deserves a response. Your bile is nothing but lies, though I won't do you the pleasure of saying you have a silver tongue. It is more a tongue that spews rubbish than anything of a convincing variety."

"Your words wound me." Sharptalon shuddered and fluffed up his feathers, peering up forlornly. "I do not know how I shall go on now that you have set me on the correct path."

"Better to have two fresh bodies to abuse than one," he said, as if to himself. "The more the merrier, isn't it, as the humans say."

Christian didn't have time to think of how the gryphon had thought of that quip as the beasts crouched, sinking back on to their hindquarters in perfect unison. Conversely, Sharptalon sat on his haunches and yawned, a smirk glinting in the corner of his eye. The flames crackled and the shadows trembled.

"Get them."

The unicorns stood shoulder to shoulder as the gryphons leapt for them and slammed their magic into their vulnerable underbellies. The first attack was the easiest to avoid and Christian's heart pounded harder than ever, mane lifting eerily from his neck as if carried by an invisible breeze. His skin tingled with power and he danced from hoof to hoof, knocking the second attack back with a single flick of magic that crackled like wildfire, leaving the gryphon hissing and clawing at his beak. There was a faint scent of singed feathers in the air and the gryphon eyed him warily, rubbing his face.

He reared, head thrown back. He'd never felt so alive! What was going on? Did it matter? The stallion landed on all four hooves, thrust his head forward and neighed with all the air his lungs could hold. Celeste looked at him like he had taken leave of his senses.

“Christian, whatever has gotten into you?” She snorted and frowned. “This is no time for play! This is very serious!”

“I know!” He shook his head apologetically, throwing a buck at one of the gryphons the colour of muddy water to catch him a glancing blow on the chest. “I’m sorry, I just feel...”

He trailed off, tongue too thick in his mouth for speech. Squealing, he lunged at a gryphon a second before he got his beak into Celeste and drove him back, kicking and snapping with a ferocity he had not known he possessed. He stampeded through the fire, scattering firewood as sparks flew from his hooves, and reared, horn alight. It flashed through every colour of the rainbow – from pink to green to orange to purple to red and more – and should have blinded him as the gryphons regrouped into a tight bunch, others from the exterior darting in to join the fray. Eight of the avians now approached and his horn, searing with unexpected heat, shot off a beam of white light.

It struck the middle of the bunch, scorching a hole in the ground, and a small, tan gryphon leapt away with a shriek, shaking his forepaw. Ducking his head, Christian charged, attacking as he bore a hole through their line and forced them back and back, away from his Celeste. His eyes burned and the shelter wavered as if he was seeing it through a magical cloak, yet he had no such invisibility spell under his hold at that time. His hooves slid in the dirt and he gasped, sucking in great, greedy breaths.

“Christian! Your magic!”

His lips were numb and words not forthcoming with the sheer volume of magic coursing through him. Screaming a stallion’s battle scream, he fought with snaps and kicks, lending power to his body with his magic to fight like a true, natural equine – only with magic to put him on a more even ground with the gryphons. It felt natural to move with his body, twisting. Sharptalon, stalking along the edge of their ‘battlefield’, tired of the game and leapt on to Christian’s back, claws digging in as the stallion hurled buck after buck.

Blasting the gryphon clear with a clear spout of magic, Celeste rescued him just in time, though not in time to escape injury altogether. Christian’s sides heaved, breathing laboured, as rivulets of blood ran down his sides, energy fading. Celeste whinnied and threw up a shield, buying them a few moments.

“You’re injured.” She nosed his side, a smear of blood staining her nose. “Put yourself behind me – now.”

Obstinately, Christian turned his body side on, shielding her from the approaching gryphons with the bulk of his body. Celeste neighed and darted back and forth but nothing she did got her around the stubborn stallion, determined to ensure she avoided injury if nothing else.

What he saw, however, was not promising. Christian’s heart sank and he gathered his magic in close, wondering if he had enough strength to transport them magically to another location. From the fear in Celeste’s eyes, that tell-tale white rim around her violet iris, she didn’t know how to get them away either. He snorted, jerking his head up and away from a gryphon’s testing swipe, no shield in place to keep the creatures away. Sharptalon bullied his way through the flock to the front of the pack, eyes glimmering. He had them now. The flock

approached, bellies slunk low to the ground as they stalked, playing at catching prey they had already caught.

Gryphons screeched and there came an unearthly bang and crackle from somewhere outside the shelter as if something had exploded and set the resulting mess on fire – Christian had seen enough documentaries to know what explosives could do. Sharptalon's head shot up, ear tufts quivering. Gryphons didn't have explosives...did they? He shook his head. If they did, they were even more doomed, if there was such a phrase to be turned. His stomach rolled as he funnelled his magic away from his body, drawing it from muscle and sinew alike to ball it up in a lump, prepared for who knew what. He had it ready to use but for what? The stallion rolled his head and leapt an impressive distance sideways as the doors slammed open, crashing off their ill-designed hinges.

But it was not gryphons that poured in.

Celeste was not the only one in for a surprise that night as a small herd of mares – which Christian recognised a moment later as the ones he had bred in their first group mating - . Karin whinnied at their head, silver horn gleaming white as she called a tremendous bout of magic to her hold. Containing it and letting it loose, the filly skidded to a halt, flinging the bundle of raw magic into the cluster of gryphons. It exploded with a bang that rocked the ground and Christian staggered, ears ringing.

Time slowed down. Shadows fizzled into nothing as the flames came under the blows of what could have been a thousand stampeding hooves for all his senses told him. The stallion leaned against Celeste, nostrils flaring, as he blearily watched the mares storm into the gryphons, an unstoppable force. Their magic gleamed, bright enough to make him blink spots away from his eyes, and their coats shone with health, vibrancy that he had not before noted radiating from them.

They had no trouble beating the gryphons back and, for all that Vale had said in the 'classroom' about magic within the herd diminishing, Christian certainly did not see any lack of magic in the herd of mares he had bred and loved, though they were not showing signs as yet that they were carrying his foals. He turned his head, looking between the herd, forcing the gryphons back over the mound of gold, and Celeste, eyes wide. She looked at him with as much confusion, hooves shuffling, though did not seem concerned, only tired. Her sides trembled and she leaned into him as he watched the fray, every mare fighting admirably and scoring hits with tooth, hoof and magic. The gryphons reeled, squawking and calling for help as their leader scrambled in the dirt, feathers in complete disarray. Sharptalon slammed his forepaw into the ground and bounded into the air, rallying his flock. Yet, not a single mare was struck as the gryphons fell back.

Where had all this magic come from? Christian shook himself, mind racing quicker than his hooves ever could have. Maybe they just needed a reason to fight. His ears burned.

Was that reason...him? Him and Celeste?

There was little time to pursue that thought – who knew the night could be so eventful when one should be slumbering? – as Karin darted up to him and bobbed her head, white nose quivering. Her body glowed with magic and she bounced from hoof to hoof as he had done earlier, unable to contain it.

“Karin!” He cried, giving a little tired bound on his hooves from sheer joy at seeing her - and so powerful! “What on earth has brought you here? How did you find us?”

The filly squeaked and bumped her nose against his, flipping up on to her kind hooves to bat away a gryphon that had gotten too close with as much ease as she would swat away a fly with her tail.

“I followed you, silly,” she said, using a term she had clearly adopted from him at one point or another. “You were not difficult to track. I am only glad that we did follow you. It was not difficult to rouse the mares and fillies from their bedchambers when they heard you may be in danger.”

Christian blinked and took a step back.

“How did you know we would be in danger? Can you see ahead with your magic? Like, into the future? You can’t have known we would be in danger all the way back in the village!”

The filly looked at him like he’d gone crazy and shook her head, ears flicking to catch the shrieks of gryphons and mares fighting it out in the background. Spilled fire from the pit spread along a wooden beam and flickered hungrily up the wall, licking and spitting as it discovered a fresh haunch to gnaw.

“Not in the slightest, Christian. When has good ever come of a unicorn slinking off into the night without a herd to guide them? Much less in *these* times.”

She spun and floored a gryphon leaping for her hindquarters, her scream that of a mare and not a filly who should have still been coming into herself and learning where her place in the world was. Every fibre in the stance of her body told him that she had already found it and it was by his side. Even as she shot him down with inexplicable logic in the heat of the moment.

Maybe that was just one more thing that he loved about her.

The battle was already won the moment the mares streamed into the shelter and Sharptalon drew his gryphons away with many a cursed and shrieked insult, drowned out by the din of their hooves. Throwing himself back into the throng at Celeste’s side once they had recovered their strength and their magic, Christian reared and pawed at the air, fire crackling along the ramshackle ceiling above him. Beams cracked and he chased the mares out with a snap and a warning, instinct taking over as he protected them. The gryphons swore and spat as they flew away, nursing their wounds, both physical and mental. Christian knew it was not the last they would see of them but they had something better on their side now, something far stronger than what they laid claim to prior.

Together, the unicorns were invincible and, if he had it his way, the whole world would know it. The gryphons would never be a threat to them and extinction would be one more word in their historical tomes in years to come as future generations laughed and learned with the old.

As the gryphons retreated, smoke curling from their makeshift shelters, the unicorns filed out of the keep in a line, each watching another’s back. Christian brought up the rear while

Celeste led at the head of the procession, finally a little forlorn and shaken now that the battle was over that she had not achieved what she had left the village to achieve: peace. Yet, at the back of the group, Christian pranced and tossed his head even as his strength drained with the lack of sleep. For he knew exactly what they had achieved and it made his heart sing.

Breeding was not the key to unicorn survival. It was much more personal than that. Far, far more personal and it was shown as clear as day in the mares he had shared love with, nips and kisses and a thrusting stallion shaft.

Speaking with Caderyn and Moirin back in the safety of the unicorn village as his wounds were tended to, Christian watched himself speak and discuss as if from behind a screen. His words did not seem his own and his body was weightless, sensation floating beyond his grasp. It was crystal clear, although not so until he had seen the mares' magic in action, when it really mattered. He watched Caderyn's and Moirin's faces fall at talk of the battle and the danger they had put themselves in, turning as mother and father to scold a most put out Celeste. But Christian called their attention back to him, telling them of the strength in the mares he'd bred. It was no coincidence. Their eyes shone with hope they had almost forgotten.

As terrifying as it was, Vale confirmed it, dragging himself with much yawning from his shelter as morning broke. Christian's love and faith for Celeste and the herd could be the only thing that had generated such increased magical power in mares who had previously not exhibited any signs of being exemplary in the field of magic. Although, the stallion itched to study them, to find out what they were now capable of, he was chased off with pinned back years and playful snaps. They told him off and sent him out of the medical shelter, teasing him that he'd have to slip out of his shaft and into something more comfortable if he wanted to test their magical abilities. The stallion paced back home with his ears back and muttering but a decidedly plumper sheath than he had arrived with.

The king and queen grilled Christian until he nearly keeled over from exhaustion and concluded – for he was far beyond the concept of making decisions in his current state – that, from Vale's research also, unicorns were more powerful with a great percentage of unicorns mating. Christian swayed as facts and figures and wispy notions spun dizzily around his skull.

He just wanted his bed and his mare.

One thing he did manage to catch, however, was that, with this new information in mind, they wanted his wedding with Celeste to go ahead as quickly as possible to strengthen the magic in the herd. That was, only if he was okay with that and what stallion would refuse saying his vows to such a beautiful mare? There had been talk for some time of them being wed and, when it came right down to it, the unicorns didn't hesitate to make decisions. And so it was settled, as simply as coming to an agreement over the evening meal. Christian chuckled, half-asleep, and told the king and queen that Celeste wouldn't even need a white dress as she was already as pure white as newly fallen snow. Caderyn and Moirin blinked blankly back at him.

The joke was a bit over their heads. And he had one more important matter to attend to as they were finally released from the medical shelter, his wounds tended to as much as their magic and potions allowed. Thankfully, none were deep and Celeste had escaped completely

unscathed physically, although there was a downtrodden nuance to her gait. Christian pushed his muzzle into her shoulder and breathed in her scent.

“Celeste...” He drew her attention gently as they made their way back from the temporary medical shelter. “You know how your father is talking about us being married as soon as possible?”

She bobbed her muzzle sleepily, eyelids drooping as the sun rose higher in the morning sky, lifting her hooves only just high enough to clear the grass with every step.

“Mmm...” She murmured an incoherent word. “Yes. Yes, I recall.”

Christian stopped her under an oak tree, their hooves crushing green leaves as older, drier sorts crinkled brown and broken. But where the new shoots sprouted on the age-old tree, the old must also be cast off.

It was time to cast off the old and embrace the new.

Awkwardly, Christian dropped to one knee, his opposite foreleg outstretched. The movement came off as more of a bow, something a circus equine would perform, than anything else yet he had Celeste’s attention.

“Christian?”

There was a question in her tone and he smiled up at her as he inclined his horn gracefully, despite the blood splatters still staining his coat.

“Celeste...” He whispered, so soft that his voice was but the lick of a summer breeze. “Would you do me the greatest honour of marrying me?”

The unicorn stood stock still, muscles quivering, and then leapt for him, bowling him in a tangle of limbs sideways to the grass. The mare kissed him all over his muzzle until her lips crashed into his and their tongues battled playfully between their muzzles despite the exhaustion wracking their limbs.

When they broke the kiss, the duo were panting, sides heaving with spent energy. Celeste squirmed and rolled Christian on to his back, resting her body more comfortably on top of his as her hind legs slid off his rump to pin him quite securely.

“It is not as if I am going to deny you, Christian!” She squealed, laying her head down along his neck. “Yes! I will marry you!”

“Couldn’t you just have said yes?” He gasped as she lunged and nipped his chin, a stinging love-bite.

Celeste giggled and ducked her head shyly, peering up at her stud through a haze of white forelock.

“Perhaps I could have simply answered in such a plain fashion. Would you have, however, expected any less of me?”

She wriggled and any words Christian may have had fled his lips as she bumped his sheath, shaft dropping in instant response. The mare snorted and brushed his throat with her lips, shifting to allow his length room to grow, flooding with blood and drawing it from other, more thoughtful, locations. The mare smirked and curled her forelegs around his, laying them on either side of his shoulders as he rolled on his back, finding himself in no position to be pushing the mare off him. Christian's ears slanted to the sides and he chuckled, abashed, as arousal trickled down on to his balls, the unicorn's marehood clearly winking and pulsing out of his sight, wanting what his body had to offer.

A passing couple of mares watched their antics, both clad in a black coat, as Celeste trapped her stallion against the ground and rubbed his shaft between. The nearest mare rolled her eyes and snorted, tossing her head, although a good-natured smile tugged at her lips.

"Those two..." She shook herself, grinning. "It is a shade early in the day for them, is it not?"

Christian and Celeste begged to differ.

*

"Mares and stallions, fillies and colts," Caderyn began, his magically booming voice echoing through the trees and over the twitching ears of every unicorn in the herd. "We are gathered here today to celebrate a momentous occasion: the joining of Christian and Celeste in marriage."

The herd cheered and stamped, whinnying to add their voice to the cacophony as Celeste and Christian stood before an ancient oak tree – one far older than the one under which Christian had proposed to Celeste.

Celeste had been suitably adorned for the wedding in an unusual blend of what Christian could only call lingerie and jewellery that drew attention to the curves and musculature of her figure. Off-white stockings – only coloured such to offset her coat – draped up all four of her sleek legs, connected by imitation suspender straps to a white harness speckled with gold notes that ran from her withers to her hindquarters. The harness dipped and rose with the muscle of her body, clearly designed precisely to fit her form, and she wore a form of undergarments that both perplexed Christian and irrevocably drew his eye.

In all her times of wearing jewellery, Christian had never seen her wear something that covered her marehood yet enhanced it so divinely. Material that shone like the finest silk and trembled like the thinnest lace – imbued with magic, no doubt – cupped her udders, connected with similar straps to the harness so that they could be removed quickly. Her marehood, on the other hand, was covered by the sheerest sliver of satin he could have imagined, the outline of her sex clearly visible through the fabric. The mare fluttered her eyelashes at him, angling her rump towards her stallion to give him a better view of the light but darkening spot of moisture on the lingerie. Her cunny winked and flexed through the fabric and Christian whinnied, upper lip quivering and lifting to sift through her scent.

Christian licked his lips and struggled not to stare as Celeste took full advantage of his position in not yet being able to mount her, winking repeatedly as the watching unicorns snickered. The stallion tossed his head, upper lip flapping comically as he sought to rein in

his frustration. His teeth and lips could make short work of those little straps, freeing her multiple udders for his attention. His cock plumped out his sheath and he nickered as he dropped, shaft soft beneath his stomach. He had been told that what he and Celeste wore would enhance their virility for the wedding ceremony but had too many butterflies in his stomach to care.

Shifting his hooves uncomfortably, he tried not to think about the royal gold adornments he bore, draped over his withers and down around his neck to end in a heavy, gold emblem. Cold cuffs linked around each fetlock, tapping his hooves when he moved, and the fillies had braided golden thread into his mane and tail so that the hair shimmered every time he moved, giving the impression that he had been draped in the golden glow of magic itself. Finally, to complete the ensemble, a line of gold links ran down his back from the circlet around the base of his neck to his tail, where it looped under his dock and kept it proudly raised. Although he felt a little too much on show, he couldn't have said that his tail wouldn't have been proudly flagged anyway when he had such a beautiful mare in front of him, waiting to take his hoof in marriage.

Having no experience of unicorn weddings, he could only believe them when they told him that it was traditional for the stallion to be as well adorned as the mare but he had a feeling they were just doing it for him. He still wasn't sure whether he should be flattered or embarrassed by the overwhelming attention. It was kind of pleasant, he had to admit.

The setting sun teased the treetops crimson and Caderyn set a glow radiating out several feet from his horn to call the cheering herd back to attention.

"Christian has done a good many deeds for the herd during the course of his otherwise short time with us. Many of the mares are now pregnant – from his efforts and those of our other, few, stallions in the herd." He exchanged a wink and sly look with Moirin. "Even I have done my part for the herd and a little bird has told me that I am also expecting foals."

The herd squealed and stamped, shouting congratulations until Caderyn cleared his throat, voice rising above the uproar to redirect back to the event at hand.

"It is most remarkable how Christian's transformation and magic has strengthened the herd, his love for Celeste and faith in the survival of unicorn-kind unshakeable at its very core. It has changed not only the life of my daughter but the life of our herd. Christian's faith and discovery has ensured that we do indeed have a life and a future to continue with. We shall forever be grateful and indebted to his kindness and willingness to assist our kind. Christian has become one of us, one of the herd, and I hope that he will never leave us."

Caderyn smiled and inclined his head respectfully towards Christian.

"Now, it is my great pleasure to unite my daughter and her stallion in marriage. The ceremony shall now commence!"

As the unicorn murmurs dropped into a respectful silence, only broken by the shuffling of hooves that couldn't be kept still, one voice pierced their peace. Caderyn stiffened but did not look up as a screech shattered their clearing, trees rustling in the lifting of a breeze.

"Your wedding is a sham."

His ‘attendance’ was hardly unexpected, although they had hoped against hope that an unwelcome visitor would not show his face again.

Sharptalon clung to the branches of the oak tree and the unicorns gasped, Caderyn reaching for his magic before the gryphon had even flapped his wings to take flight. Christian shook his head, standing protectively before the king, and tracked the gryphon’s flight with his eyes as the avian circled the clearing, the oak tree at its centre.

“We are not afraid of you, Sharptalon,” Celeste called out, her voice strong and clear. “Show us your worst and we shall send you squalling with your tail between your legs. There is nothing for us to fear from you.”

The gryphon cackled, specks in the sky plummeting towards them and quickly taking shape as other gryphons. Gathering his strength, Christian tensed and nodded to the watching unicorns, his eyes grazing the gaze of every mare he had bred. They knew he needed them. His cock throbbed in memory but there was no time for that. Karin braced herself, horn set alight in rippling, white flames. Although she was dressed in a similar manner to Celeste, only without the gold accents – which were for the unicorn ‘bride’ alone – her attire would not hinder her movements and there was a fire in her eyes that he had seen that night in the gryphon stronghold. She needed no one to protect her.

Hurling themselves to the ground, the attacking gryphons – clad in all colours from tan to the most brilliant shades reminiscent of precious gems – screamed a battle cry that shook the ground beneath their hooves. Sharptalon launched himself from the tree, wings spread, and lunged for Celeste with his tail lashing. His beak gaped, a black, cavernous yawn of death, and he screeched like a banshee as he snapped where Celeste’s head had been a moment ago. The unicorn leapt sideways, twisted and slammed her horn into the side of his head. He just barely moved far enough away, writhing in midair like a cat, to spare himself a strike that would have otherwise knocked him out cold, and hissed viciously.

“Say goodbye to your mate, princess,” he snarled, his feathery tufts of ears slanted back. “It will be the last you ever see of him. You will watch him die.”

“I hardly think that will come to be.”

They both turned in time to see Karin slam her back hooves neatly into Sharptalon’s gut, sending him flying backwards, head over paws, through the air. The gryphon squalled like a hatchling and righted himself with difficulty, shaking his head back and forth as if caught by a dizzy spell.

While the gryphon recovered, Karin whipped around to position herself at Christian’s side with one mare on either side of him. Facing down his enemy, the stallion snorted and set his horn aglow, light flooding in to it as if drawn from the environment around him. He built up the force until his legs trembled with the strength it took to hold it, holding Sharptalon’s gaze as a grunt broke his lips. Too late, the gryphon realised what he was doing and scrambled to escape, wings flapping as if he had taken leave of his senses and forgotten how to fly. Christian rolled his head and tipped it back as the end of his horn glowed red-hot with pure, white light, teeth clenched and jaw aching. All for his herd.

He only hoped he'd have enough energy left over for the mating ceremony.

Christian drew his magic in close and hurled it out with as much force as he could muster. There was no way Sharptalon could get away in time. Although the gryphon flapped madly, there was little height to be gained, and the full force of the blast smacked him in the small of his back. He flew head over paws, fighting and failing to right himself with one wing hanging at a deadly angle. He screeched and cried as he plummeted to the ground, landing in the midst of the unicorns who quickly surrounded him, horns lowered. The gryphons diving above pulled up and circled, keening as they awaited further instructions from their leader.

Christian took a deep breath, sides expanding, as Celeste and Karin wove their magic together, eyes narrowed in concentration. The filly's tongue stuck out from the side of her mouth and he chuckled, though tried to be more interested in what they were doing than admiring her in such a dire situations. Strands of magic, shimmering so that they were impossible to pin down in any one place, flickered in and out of one another, floating over the crowd. Its purpose soon became evident as it dropped over Sharptalon, effectively sealing him within a magical cage.

Leaving his side, Celeste walked calmly up to the cage and peered through the 'netting' at the gryphon inside. Sharptalon flapped and seethed, snapping at the barrier and leaping back as it stung his beak, smoke curling up from the blackened tip.

"Sharptalon, you shall atone for your crimes and shall harm no more. No more shall you bring destruction to our land." She half-reared, emotion getting the better of her for a fleeting moment. "For all your threats...all that you have striven to carry out. No more. Not all gryphons think as you do. If they will not bring you to justice, we shall ensure you reside in guarded confinement for the remainder of your natural life."

"Oh, princess," he crooned, fluffing out his feathers the best he could with one wing drooping on the grass. "You still can't bring yourself to kill me? You have me trapped. All it would take is one little spell to dispatch me forever. Don't you want that?"

The mare shook herself, horn shooting off silver sparks.

"I see your tongue is as silver as ever but that shall not aid you here." Celeste's ears flicked back. "I had hoped to bring peace between us. I still hope for a resolution we may all be proud of."

"Peace shall never be had!" The mad gryphon screeched, flapping one wing and sending feathers flying. "My flock!"

Throwing his head back, he screamed – the sound somewhere between a screech that an eagle would unleash in threat and a lion's feisty roar. It reverberated through the clearing and the gryphons turned their beady eyes on the unicorns as one. Folding their wings in neatly to their sides, they dropped like stones, gaining speed with every passing second. Unicorns panicked and shot off magical blasts at random, using their magic to hurl any projectiles they may at the gryphon in hopes of knocking them out of the air. It was a valiant effort on the spur of the moment but in vain for the gryphons kept coming regardless of how many of their comrades were felled.

“Together!” Karin leapt to the front of the line, horn sending out streams of magic above her head in all directions. “Together we may push them back. Hold!”

The herd nodded and, steeling themselves to face the rapidly approaching horde, linked their magic with Karin’s, much like how she had done with Celeste to create the cage for Sharptalon. This one, however, had to be much larger to keep the gryphons at bay. With every unicorn that joined her spell, the net became a little larger, sometimes only marginally so when the unicorns with less magical strength – for the time being – did what they could. The mares bred by Christian proved by far the strongest and sweat darkened their coats as they forced every last drop of magic they had to give into the force of the herd, directed by Karin. The filly stood at their head, the force of all the magic whipping her mane off her neck, with her horn held defiantly high.

The net swelled with the herd’s combined power and even Caderyn and Moirin added their years of accumulated magic to the cause, bolstering it further. Covering the entire unicorn herd, it sealed its edges into the ground, encasing them in a protective ‘bubble’ that could not be penetrated despite the ‘gaps’ in its defence. Sparks crackled and fizzled between fronds of the net and the gryphons pulled up, snarling and hissing as they clipped the barrier. Singed feathers drifted to the grass and Karin shook one off her head, a muscle twitching in her jaw.

Although Sharptalon cried out orders, nothing the gryphons did seemed to get them any closer to the herd. Several flew away with blackened paws and talons after attempting to brave the barrier and their cries of pain were more than enough to ward back the others, who approached with a deal more caution. They poked and prodded the barrier, shuddering back when magic stung their paws, finding no weakness in its defence, magic jumping between strands in the net like wildfire leaping from one tree to another.

Karin neighed and reared, striking out at the air, the herd joining her in victory that some could have called premature but sustained their spirits, bodies heaving from the energy it took to maintain the protective shield. Prancing, Karin threw her head back and shrieked her defiance at the head of the herd, protecting all those that she loved even as her legs trembled faintly. Only Christian saw. Her pride for the herd was *infectious*. Christian bared his teeth in a feral, equine grin of triumph and spun on the spot, kicking out at nothing in particular just for the sheer hell of it. Magic snapped off his horn like a bowstring drawn too tightly and seeped into the net, forcing it to become larger, pushing the gryphons back and back and back.

Circling above the shield, the gryphons hesitated, looking from comrade to comrade as if hoping that another would have some better idea of what they should be doing. But no answer was forthcoming. Sharptalon screeched.

“Fools!” He screamed, striking his cage and promptly flying back into the opposite side from the resulting shockwave. “Imbeciles! I shall have you for treason if you do not fight! Fight, damn you! Are you gryphons or hatchlings cowering in the nest! Take them! Free me! Let us strike back at the unicorns together and take what is rightfully ours and what was ours all along!”

They paid him little mind, wing beats slowing as they caught the updraft above the tree line and conserved their strength, several clustering together in midair as if to confer. Sharptalon shrieked and made sounds in what Christian could only assume was a language only

gryphons understood. None of the noises sounded very pleasant, that much was sure. Perhaps he was bearing witness to gryphon swearing? The stallion stifled a chuckle, focusing on supporting the shield with every ounce of magic he possessed, although the attacks had trailed off. Celeste, standing guard beside him, shook her head sadly and peered down at him, moisture pricking at the corners of her eyes.

“The battle is already won, Sharptalon.” Celeste frowned, pausing a moment to add a greater volume of her magic to the looming, growing shield. “Surrender now and no more of your kind will come to harm.”

“*Surrender* is a filthy word, Celeste,” he snarled. “I shall not surrender and shall take my leave when your body lies cold and dead in the ground.”

He leapt back from the bars of his cage, eyes wide, as Christian snorted hotly into his face, only stopped from slamming into the gryphon by the magical barrier. He ground his teeth together and pawed the ground, throwing up clots of earth. The gryphon cowered, body curved away from the raging stallion with fire in his eyes.

“If I had my way,” he said in a low, dangerous tone. “You would not live to see the close of this day for the threats you held over Celeste and the fear you have brought into our hearts. You were offered peace and rejected hope in favour of war – for what, I will never fathom. But the unicorns are kinder than I and have lived with more peaceful morals than I have for the majority of my life. It is only for the herd’s kindness and peaceful will that you live. Remember that.”

Sharptalon ducked his beak between his forepaws, fluttering his wings like a hatchling cornered by an angry parent. Christian half-reared and wove back and forth before the cage even as Celeste murmured soothing words to him. When he stopped, his gaze was stony, horn letting off trailing wisps of grey smoke as if to release the red-hot anger in his gut. Christian inhaled slowly and deeply, calming himself. Celeste’s scent tickled his nose.

“Never cross me or my mates ever again, Sharptalon. Or I will come for you. And you will regret the day you ever made threats against Celeste.”

Turning his back on the stuttering gryphon, broken at the pinnacle, Christian braced his shoulders, head high. He nodded to Caderyn and Moirin, dipping his horn respectfully.

“He can rot in confinement until the end of his days. This fight is over.”

Taking a deep breath, he focused on the shield, dizziness swamping him. Like pushing through quicksand, he forced it aside and lanced his magic into the barrier. Sending out spikes of magic like the spines of a porcupine, he turned the shield into a weapon, firing off rounds of magic in all directions the gryphons may be – which was mostly above. They shrieked and scattered, crashing into one another in their haste to evade and avoid injury. More than one, struck square on, spiralled to the ground with a keening cry. Seeing what the stallion was doing, the other unicorns followed his lead and joined in the attack, multi-coloured spikes of raw power flashing through the sky and searing leaves from the trees.

The gryphons cawed and flapped and dodged but nothing they did, working alone, got them any closer to escape or attack. The cluster that had seemed to be conferring earlier called out

to their brethren and could be heard, very faintly, to be urging them to come under their wing and retreat.

They had no care for the gryphon that had led them into such a mess. Sharptalon slumped to the ground, sides heaving for breath that he couldn't quite scrape into his lungs. Sorrow? Christian wasn't sure the barbarian could feel such a thing. It didn't matter. He'd never hurt another living soul for the rest of his days.

Led by their strongest, the gryphons retreated with not a single look back that the unicorns could catch but it was only when they were far, far out of sight that they dropped the shield. Warily, they kept their magic within reach, cautious and wondering if the attack would continue. Karin exhaled a sigh that Christian had not noticed she was holding, head dropping to relieve the strain in her neck. Christian nuzzled her withers and turned to Caderyn and Moirin just in time to see Sharptalon being escorted away by their strongest unicorns – no doubt to solitary confinement until they deemed a time fit to deal with his future.

Nickering, Christian cast the unicorn king a questioning look, too tired to consider if his lips would still form words.

“There is no reason to delay the ceremony further,” Caderyn explained, a tired but relieved smile on his lips. “Please, my herd – gather around.”

Swaying, Christian struggled to focus on the words binding him to Celeste in the ceremony until a small vial was unexpectedly forced between his lips. He drank reflexively and blinked at the white filly in a daze as Karin danced before him, light on her hooves.

“Drink up,” she nickered, dropping a flirty kiss on his cheek. “Wouldn't want you to fall asleep too early on your wedding night now, would we?”

Chuckling, Christian shook his head, hooves shifting as warm life flooded back into his limbs. The ceremony had moved on quickly without him being mentally present but the unicorns were quickly appearing more lively as Karin flitted between them, dispensing potions like they were sweets. He expected that there would be many more vials and spells to keep them going for the night ahead. He suppressed his smirk, tail flicking cockily. Stronger already, he met Celeste's gaze as Caderyn wove pink tinted magic around them, linking their horns together with a force that could never be broken. Christian smiled. He'd never want to be without his lover for as long as he lived.

Let the bond be tied.

“Christian and Celeste,” Caderyn smiled, horn casting a rain of magical droplets that fell like liquid but dissolved harmlessly on their coats. “It is my utmost pleasure to declare you stallion and mare this eve. May your life together be long, prosperous and complete with love. May you never be without the other at your side.”

Although unicorns would not have normally kissed during the wedding ceremony, Christian readily welcomed the touch of Celeste's lips on his own, warmth flooding his muzzle as she deepened it and pushed her tongue against his. He groaned into the kiss, cock once again dropping and bouncing beneath his belly, though he could not feel ashamed of being so

publicly on show after all that had taken place. It was almost a relief to be able to express this part of himself after the turmoil and the fighting.

“Now the best part of the ceremony may begin,” Celeste whispered to Christian with a devilish grin as she broke the kiss. “My husband and I must be the first to initiate the pleasure-making portion of the ceremony.”

Christian nickered and lipped her neck lovingly.

“It’s as if you even don’t have to ask, Celeste.”

She squealed playfully and swung her hindquarters towards him as the herd giggled and tossed their heads. Her marehood winked, pulsing beneath the satin, and Christian delicately took it between his teeth, tugging it to the side so that it cupped and framed her plump sex gorgeously. He licked his lips, tasting her on him, and ran his tongue from her engorged clitoris to the top of her vent, feeling her push and pull against his tongue. Celeste rolled her head and thrust her hindquarters back to him, tail high and pushed out of the way in her eagerness as her marehood winked and pushed out her arousal, a thick drop trickling over her cunny lips and drooling to the ground as the volume increased.

Christian pushed his tongue into her twitching sex and snorted hotly, warm breath washing over her marehood and up under her tail. Celeste whickered and flicked her tail, catching him across the head so that his world was momentarily nothing but a white wash of tail and the scent of his love’s treasure. The teasing would not last long – not if Celeste had her way – but he enjoyed it all the same and drew the tension in his mare taut as she stomped and snorted.

“Now, Christian,” she whinnied, marehood winking like she would never have him again. “I need you to mate with me! Quell your teasing and make me your mare!”

Christian’s lips tugged up on one side in a stallion smirk and he pulled sharply away, cock bouncing and throbbing. He needed no magical aids to breed his unicorn bride and mounted her with a sense of familiarity built up over their months together, pushing forward confidently until the tip of his cock brushed her warm, wet marehood. She winked, begging him in, and he grunted as he thrust, sealing the deal and spearing into her up to the medial ring. Christian groaned. It had been too long since they had last mated. Well, it had only been a few days while the wedding ceremony was undergoing preparations but that was still far, far too long in his books.

Snorting, he withdrew only to slam in again with greater force as his mare squealed beneath him.

“Does that mean you’re making me your stallion too?”

He huffed in her ear, catching her mane between his teeth as he drove in to the hilt. Celeste groaned and rocked back into his thrust, legs trembling though not because she could not bear his weight.

“You are already my stallion, Christian,” she managed to force out between laboured breaths, ears back and nostrils flared in need. “You were mine from the very first moment I laid eyes on you.”

“And you were mine.”

Christian’s skin tingled as the golden accents on his royal jewellery took effect. They glowed gently, almost so that no one would notice – in all truth, the unicorn herd were beginning to look to one another for attention and love, stimulated by the scene before the aged oak tree. They wouldn’t have seen anyway, caught up in one another as they were. But Christian felt it and so did Celeste, the mare pushing against him with greater urgency as he thrust rapidly, spurning a short burst of an orgasm out of her. Whinnying, Celeste’s passage squeezed around his shaft and he grunted like a stag in rut, ramming in even as she tried to keep him there, clenching down with enough force that the pleasure resided on the edge of what was bearable.

The herd cheered and whinnied, joining up with their own partners – both male and female, as their inclinations pleased them – to celebrate the union of the unicorns that had brought them so far in such a short span of time. Moirin turned her back to Caderyn and, although he had clearly implied that she was with foal, winked and presented, her mottled grey and pink marehood pulsing. Her sex twitched and she braced herself as she lifted her tail and released a stream of strongly scented urine, splattering across the roots of the tree, to let her mate know that she was ready. It was not as if he needed any encouragement, however, not even after all their years together. Caderyn nickered, tossed his head and brought his weight gently down on Moirin’s hindquarters, only pausing to shoot Christian a cheeky wink that the distracted stallion did not see. No – he had a mare beneath him and that was all that mattered.

Huffing, Christian nipped and lipped at the base of Celeste’s neck, lips tickling her withers as he slammed in. The mare held herself firm and gasped as she was bred, her partner’s forelegs tightening around her. Quicker and harder, he thrust like a stallion possessed, presented with the last mating he would ever have. He grunted, tail flagging as orgasm swiftly made itself know – though he held himself back as much as possible – the rocking of Celeste’s body making one of the straps holding the lingerie over her udders snapping free. She squealed as two of her udders were freed and the stallion above her chuckled hoarsely, ramming in roughly until the combined shaking of their bodies broke loose the remainder, leaving Celeste’s heavy udders swinging without any tantalising concealment. The straps clearly were not intended for such activities but neither could bring themselves to care in the moment.

Groaning, Christian thrust several times in quick succession, finally pushed over the edge by his mare climaxing on his cock, her passage twitching and clenching until he expelled all his breath in one great snort. Slamming in, balls slapping her marehood and clit lightly, he whinnied his orgasm to their voyeurs, the stallions calling back as they too reached climax, one by one. He trembled and stamped as Celeste rocked back beneath him, grinding her rump into him and squeezing down with such force that he couldn’t move back. She eventually relaxed the pressure around his shaft with a grin that she cast back over her withers, lingerie more than a little askew from their activities. Christian nickered and stretched forward, neck aching from the strain, so that they could just about brush muzzles in a velvety kiss.

As he slid off Celeste’s back, soft cock refusing to retreat back into its sheath, a very familiar filly approached with a coy smile gracing her lips and a sparkle in her eyes that had not been there before. Ever the one to show off, Celeste raised her tail, flexing her marehood to put the thick, delicious creampie of her sex on display. As the filly and stallion looked on with equal

lust, stallion semen oozed over Celeste's sex, pushed out by her winking, and trailed a shiny path over her clitoris: the mare nickered wantonly. Christian's cock flexed, throbbing with blood, as Karin ducked her head, looking up at him through a haze of forelock, though there was no longer any shyness in her expression.

The little filly had grown.

"Christian."

She was as lovely as an angel in her wedding attire – the lingerie-like design – like the elder Celeste.

"For your ceremony," she said, inclining her horn towards the box. "I hope it brings pleasure to all the unicorns here today. It is imbued with magic and..." She trailed off, lips quirking into a secretive smile. "It is best that you see it for yourself. It will be the best kind of surprise though, I promise you."

Curious, Christian nudged open the box and leapt back with a snort as something blue shot out, waving a million tiny strands in all directions like the arms of a sea anemone. He eyed it suspiciously as it hovered in midair, shades of blue changing seemingly as it pleased. It floated towards him and he shot backwards, narrowly avoiding a couple of mares enjoying the pleasure of one another's bodies. They did lack for stallions, after all. Karin bounded after him, as light on her hooves as a fawn.

"Do not be frightened," the filly giggled, bumping the oddly undulating mass with her nose. "It is something I created, for our pleasure. For the pleasure of the entire herd."

Turning her hindquarters to him, she presented, marehood pulling up and winking, releasing a thick stream of arousal as she braced herself. He paused, momentarily distracted from her gift, and edged closer, cock dropping and bouncing against his belly as he flexed. Karin swayed her rump hypnotically from side to side, tail lifted high. Unlike Celeste, her wedding lingerie did not need to be pulled to the side and left both her marehood and udders free to be teased.

Christian dipped his nose to her winking sex, lipping and teasing her plump, pink lips until the filly squirmed and stamped, teeth snapping with a short, sharp click as she demanded to be mounted – immediately!

"How could I refuse, my darling?"

Landing on her back, the filly nickered and winked against the questing head of his cock, which left smears of pre cum in its wake to combine with her sexual juices. His nose twitched at the exclusive cocktail of scents, upper lip curling back to better take her in. He whispered sweet nothings in her ear, hindquarters working as he sought to, yet again, make her his. His cock sank home, pushing into her folds as if he belonged there, and Karin neighed, rolling her body back against his.

Christian, lost in the pleasure of breeding the filly, didn't notice a tickling sensation on his rump as he thrust. He did, however, notice when the blue, tentacle mass wove its way around his tail and squirmed over his tight pucker of a tail hole. His eyes shot wide and he squealed,

kicking out at an angle at a foe that could not be reached with brute force, nearly toppling both him and Karin over with their bodies joined together. Snorting the filly raised a hind hoof in half-warning, shaking it in the air like a human would shake a scolding finger.

“It shall not hurt you, you silly oaf!” She bobbed her head. “Relax, Christian, and enjoy it. I promise it will bring only greater pleasure to our mating.” He looked unsure, the whites of his eyes showing, and she softened her gaze. “I shall have it please me also. It is purely a magical creation, although its effects should be limitless. You only have to think of the pleasure you desire and it will oblige.”

Closing her eyes, the filly ground back into the hesitantly thrusting stallion – he couldn’t stop his body from moving completely, regardless of his concern over *what* that thing was going to do under his poor tail. He tried to ignore it, driving into Karin with an instinctual buck, as the pressure beneath his tail lightened. He snorted as it split into two masses of an equal size – magic was mysterious – and the new tentacle-y mass wafted down his side and around to Karin. He lost sight of it as it ducked below his barrel and dropped onto Karin’s pure white coat. The filly shuddered all of a sudden as his thrusts grew stronger, head rolling.

“It is around my udders, Christian,” she panted, eyes lidded in pleasure. “It is pulling and sucking at my teats as if it has a mouth of its own...” Her voice broke in a moan. “It feels so delightful... You really must try out its pleasure... See what it may allow you to experience too.”

Her formality broke as moans passed her lips, the filly lost in a world where ecstasy raced towards its inevitable peak. Bolder, Christian relaxed his mind, leaving her gift to do as it pleased; she’d clearly had something in mind for him. It squirmed over his pucker, the stallion flinching, and squirted some manner of lubricant under his tail. Wriggling back and forth, it applied gentle, barely discernible pressure until a slim tendril eased into his passage, slowly pushing deeper and deeper. The stallion flushed to the tips of his ears, still thrusting through his admitted distraction.

Karin nickered and pulled her head back to his, neck drawn up at a harsh angle with her lips parted. The tentacle widened, spreading out his anal ring, and Christian gave a strangled snort that died on his lips as Karin chuckled breathlessly. Something told him that Karin had had her fair of experience and ‘fun’ with this magical toy also. The thought sent an electric shock through his body and he thrust furiously, the tentacle matching his pace as he grew increasingly used to the sensation. It curled up against a sensitive spot that he had not known existed and he squealed, half-kicking out as need flared up, red hot and demanding.

By the gods... Christian rolled his head, snorting heavily as Karin brushed her nose back against his, twisting her neck to reach him.

“Does it not feel good?” She breathed, breath catching. “Oh, Christian... My love, I am so close already.”

And he could feel that she was too. The filly clenched and squeezed around his shaft as if begging him to breed her harder and deeper, although he had already bottomed out inside her. Gritting his teeth, the stallion gripped her tightly and thrust roughly, rocking her whole body forward as the tentacles continued to work their magic around her udders. From her moans and gasps, he believed them to be nipping and sucking on her teats and, for a moment, wished

his lips were wrapped around them. He grunted and rammed in deep, tail flagging. The filly's lips no longer worked, words blending into one, long moan of abject pleasure that could not be encompassed by language.

Christian thrust, welcoming the rising pleasure, which could not have been denied even if he'd wanted to hold out. The tentacle squelched around the base of his tail without dampening it and stretched him out further; he nearly lost his balance as it pressed harder against that spot inside his 'under tail', spots dancing before his eyes. Who could have known that a little teasing there could feel so good? His cock leaked warm drools of pre into Karin as he thrust but it was not long before orgasm flickered up, deeper and more powerful than he'd ever felt.

He'd experienced many orgasms with Celeste, the mares and Karin, yet this one was different yet the same simultaneously – there were no words for what he experienced. Climax trapped him and dragged him along, muscles tensing all at once. His hindquarters jerked against the filly without warning, twitching up to her rump, as he expelled what felt like several orgasms worth of seed, pumping her fuller and fuller, semen leaking out of her cunny despite the tight seal his cock provided. Groaning, Christian rolled his hips and thrust and thrust until he could thrust no more, the tentacle still working over his insides gently, pushing back and forth with all the tenderness of a long-time lover.

The filly, spurred on by his orgasm and her subsequent, gooey filling, shuddered into an orgasm of her own, body trembling as her forelegs buckled from ecstasy. Half-conscious in climax, she dragged a vial from a little cloth saddle bag, tucked away at the shoulder of her ensemble, and made herself drink. She made a face at the taste and tossed it away when every drop of the pink liquid had been drained, licking her lips as orgasm made her eyes roll back into her head. She squeezed around her stud's shaft, taking everything he had to give until he could give no more.

Yet there would be plenty more to come that night, she could be sure of it.

Christian's sides heaved, breath coming with difficulty. As his cock softened within the filly's clenching passage, the blue tentacles gently eased out of his anal ring and fled to spread pleasure amongst the herd. He caught sight of it as it split into many more blue masses, one slipping beneath the barrel of a stallion with his muzzle buried beneath a mare's tail, slurping at her winking, messy marehood, drooling with stallion cream. The unicorn started, tail swishing, as the mass slipped beneath his stomach and wrapped itself around his hard cock, forming a sort of sleeve around it. From the stallion's trembles, Christian could thought it may have been sucking the stallion's length, pushing back and forth like a mare would give a stallion oral. Or a stallion give a stallion oral, for there were more than a couple of stallions putting on a show in the celebrations of the herd for the waiting, impatient mares. He half-smiled, slowly easing back as Karin cast him a tired yet cheeky wink.

"One more thing, Christian," Karin panted as her stallion slipped off her back, tail flagged proudly and heart hammering. "Celeste?"

The mare eased around Christian to stand side by side with Karin, horn sparkling with purple notes. He widened his eyes – just where had she popped up from? Had she been watching him breed Karin the whole time? – and shook his head, bumping his nose against hers with

the faintest of cheesiest grins. *Hope you don't mind, sweetheart, just breeding another lady in front of you. Did you enjoy the show?*

Celeste didn't seem to mind, the aroma of her arousal hanging thickly around her, his seed still dripping from her stretched marehood. And still she winked, half-swinging her hindquarters towards him simply to show off. She bounced on her hooves and nickered, stretching out her neck towards him and drawing it back suddenly, mischief in the line of her body.

"We wanted to tell you together... Now seems like the perfect time, you are married to Celeste and..." The filly blushed, the tips of her ears turning pink. "Celeste and I are pregnant!"

Christian pulled his head back, certain for a moment that they were mistaken. Understandably, the potions had made him more virile but surely it would take longer for them to be with foal? Yet...it made sense with all the breeding sessions they had enjoyed together. And Celeste had been a little rounded – pleasantly so – than usual, if he had to admit the truth of what he'd noticed. When he was sure they were not teasing him, he squealed and reared, energy coursing through him with such vigour that it had to be expended somehow. He bumped noses with Celeste and Karin and nuzzled down their flanks, resting his cheek where his foals were growing. His heart swelled with pride and, pressing his side against Celeste's, he kissed Karin softly on the lips. The filly shivered under his touch, melting into him.

"In that case, my sweet..." Christian fumbled for words, overcome by good fortune – everything was coming right at long last. "You must now live with Celeste and me, so that we may raise our family together."

Karin started, ears twitching.

"Live...with you? Celeste? Is that truly allowed? May I live with you and Christian?"

The mare nickered and nuzzled the filly's cheek softly.

"I would not have it any other way."

Celeste spun and pressed her rump to the side of the filly's so that they presented themselves side by side, tails lifted and beautiful in their wedding lingerie. Nickering, Christian bobbed his muzzle back and forth, eyes near enough bulging out of their sockets. He looked between the mares with the full, heavy udders simply begging for attention and their winking marehoods, pushing out the cocktail of their fluids and his semen, thick and potent. Both carried his foal in their bellies and he huffed, stamping a front hoof. Giggling, Celeste raised her hind hoof teasingly and jiggled it in the air, making her udders swing temptingly. Her marehood flexed, pulsing with need as she urinated, demonstrating her readiness, yet again, in the best way her body knew how. Urine soaked into the grass between her hind hooves and Christian snaked out his head close to the stream, upper lip back as he played with the scents. His cock slapped against his belly.

“Which one of us will you take first, Christian?” She nickered slyly. “Your mate or your sweetheart? Or perhaps the two of us will please one another until you come to a decision. Either way, we shall have our fill of you tonight and more.”

Christian shook his head, the grin never once leaving his lips. It was the best kind of dilemma to have and he doubted he would be faced with such a problem for very much longer. Karin winked to Celeste and dipped down on to her bent forelegs, wriggling beneath Celeste’s stomach. She nipped and tossed away what was left of the straps that had held the lingerie covering the mare’s udders, playing her lips across them sensually. Winking, Celeste shuddered and groaned, pulling her tail up and to the side, her gleaming sex on show.

Christian grunted and made his decision – though it had half been made for him already by the playful, pregnant mares – pushing up and over Celeste’s back to claim her, as he did every day, for his own. His heart hammered in his chest as his cock caught and drove deep, Celeste squealing like a filly taking her first length. Oh, his mare... He lipped her neck. He was already hers and always hers to claim.

And he wouldn’t have had his life any other way than with the two mares by his side. He groaned as he thrust into his mate, Karin suckling and nipping wickedly at her teats. Celeste cried out as orgasm claimed her, shaking beneath him. Throwing his head back, he neighed to the first stars pricking the twilight sky as the sun finally dipped below the horizon, allowing night to reclaim the forest. Karin nickered, drawing Celeste’s teats into her lips and suckling noisily. He groaned, tail flicking back and forth as the sounds and scents of the herd enjoying itself flooded his senses. Everything had finally come right for the unicorns at long, long last.

A smile flickered over his lips. Everything had come right and would only become better as time went on. He grunted, driving in deep to Celeste as she arched her neck, muscles twitching. Yes, there was always more pleasure to come. And a lifetime of it with his mates. Christian whinnied loud and proud, tail flagging and swishing madly.

What more could a stallion desire?